Republic of Rwanda

Ministry of Gender and Family Promotion

NATIONAL TRANSFORMATIVE STRATEGY ENGAGING MEN AND BOYS FOR GENDER EQUALITY PROMOTION

Foreword

The Ministry of Gender and Family Promotion (MIGEPROF) is the Central Government institution mandated to ensure strategic harmonization of national policies, strategies, programs, and projects aimed at promoting gender equality, building resilient and stable families, and protecting children's rights to facilitate their integration into the national socio-economic and political landscapes.

Recognizing that traditional gender norms and masculine ideals have perpetuated power imbalances and gender disparities, it is crucial to actively engage men and boys in the promotion of gender equality. This engagement involves preventing and eliminating all forms of violence and fostering a sense of responsibility in men and boys to break the cycle of violence through attitudinal and behavioral changes, integrated education, and training that emphasize peace and harmony.

The development and dissemination of a national gender transformative strategy that engages men and boys for gender equality promotion aligns with the fifth priority area of the revised National Gender Policy 2021. This strategy advocates for the effective involvement of men and boys in gender promotion initiatives, challenging sociocultural and patriarchal attitudes, and reshaping gender-responsive manhood through transformative approaches.

The strategy underscores that the active participation of men and boys is essential for advancing gender equality and empowering women and girls. It promotes gender transformative methods to foster positive masculinities characterized by care, nurturing, empathy, and equity. These approaches are critical tools for addressing power dynamics and gender norms that underpin discrimination at structural, community, and individual levels. The strategy also acknowledges that while gender inequalities privilege men and boys and disproportionately harm women and girls, they negatively affect the well-being of men and boys.

Achieving our medium- and long-term gender equality objectives is a collective responsibility. Government institutions, civil society organizations (CSOs), faith-based organizations (FBOs), and non-governmental organizations (NGOs) must all engage men and boys by referring to this national transformative strategy. Together, we can promote a more equitable society for all.

Consolée UWIMANA
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Acronyms

CSOs	Civil Society Organizations
EMB	Engaging Men and Boys (approach)
ECD	Early Childhood Development
GMO	Gender Monitoring Office
GTA	Gender Transformative Approach
LODA	Local Administrative Entities Development Agency
MIGEPROF	Ministry of Gender and Family Promotion
MINALOC	Ministry of Local Government
MINECOFIN	Ministry of Finance and Economic Planning
MINEDUC	Ministry of Education
MINICOM	Ministry of Trade and Industry
MoH	Ministry of Health
NISR	National Institute of Statistics of Rwanda
NST	National Strategy for Transformation
GBV	Gender-Based Violence
STEM	Science, Technology, Engineering, and Math
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training

Executive summary

The Revised National Gender Policy (2021) explicitly calls for engaging men and boys (EMB) in gender promotion, as key partners in promoting gender equality and equity. It recognizes that "men's resistance resulting from cultural norms, misunderstanding of gender principles and dimensions due to inadequate gender-related education as well as the lack of adequate mechanisms for engaging them, prevent them from playing a central role in gender promotion" (Policy Issue 5.1). The Rwanda National Transformative Strategy Engaging Men for Gender Equality was therefore developed to respond to one of the gender policy actions (5.1.1), which specifically recommends "to develop a National Men Engage Strategy to ensure that men and boys are effectively engaged in gender related interventions across sectors".

This Strategy recognizes that meaningful engagement of men and boys is critical in advancing gender equality and women's and girls' empowerment. It recommends the use of a gender transformative approach to promote positive masculinities, i.e. caring, nurturing, empathic, and equitable identities as men and boys, as the key to challenge power dynamics and gender norms that reinforce gender inequalities at the structural, community, and individual level. It acknowledges that while such inequalities grant men and boys their privileges and power in society and disproportionately harm women and girls, they also negatively impact men's and boys' lives in different ways. The transformation will ultimately be beneficial to everyone.

This Strategy suggests that men and boys should be engaged both as allies to women and girls and as co-beneficiaries, through initiatives that highlight men's and boys' roles and responsibilities in dismantling unequal power relations and in promoting women's and girls' empowerment, while also identifying the benefits of gender equality for men and boys themselves.

Elaboration of the proposed National Transformative Strategy Engaging Men for Gender Equality Promotion relied on a highly participatory, consultative approach involving major stakeholders, including high-level gender equality and women's empowerment actors. An extensive review of policy documents was supplemented by an assessment of relevant existing best practices at the country, regional and international levels.

This strategy details approaches for engaging men and boys in gender equality and women's empowerment—while simultaneously advancing women's rights and respecting women's and girls' leadership, voices, and spaces—under specific thematic areas which are aligned with the three interconnected pillars of the National Strategy for Transformation (NST), which

include social transformation, economic transformation and transformational governance. The three specific thematic areas proposed in this Strategy are: social inclusion (which includes the sub-areas of health, education, gender-based violence [GBV], and unpaid care work), economic empowerment and climate justice (which includes employment and job creation, access to finance and climate justice) and transformational governance (which includes participation in leadership positions and women's voice and participation in decision making).

The strategy calls for a cross-cutting approach, involving government institutions, districts, private entities, development partners, civil society organizations, including feminist and women's rights organizations and community members. The Ministry of Gender and Family Promotion (MIGEPROF) is responsible for overseeing the strategy's implementation.

The operationalization of the strategy does not necessarily require separate budget allocations but entails analyzing how core government resources can be strategically allocated and relevant initiatives supported.

Introduction

Gender shapes individuals' lives in all societies, involving the learning of social roles, behaviours, values, and attitudes associated with being male or female. Masculinities and femininities are socially constructed, and this process, known as "gender socialization," begins before birth and continues throughout life, influenced by various social settings (Pilcher & Whelehan, 2017).

Gender construction perpetuates a social system, or 'gendered order' characterized by masculine domination over femininities, forming a system called "patriarchy", disadvantaging women and girls (Matthews, 1984; Connell, 1995). Dominant masculinities contribute to behaviors which perpetuate gender inequalities and disproportionately harm women and girls, by exposing them to various forms of GBV, limiting their sense of self-worth and the value they are given within a society, preventing them from fully enjoying their rights, liberties, and opportunities, limiting their voice and participation in decision-making, and hampering their involvement in economic and political empowerment.

These behaviors also negatively impact men and boys, pushing them to live up to a narrow set of prevailing, rigid standards that limit their health-seeking behaviors, affect their mental health, and push them towards risk-taking behaviors.

Efforts to advance global gender equality should also include redefining dominant masculinities as 'positive' or 'healthy,' encouraging nurturing, compassionate, and caring behaviors in men, equitable interactions with women, and addressing negative behaviours (Lomas 2013). To achieve wider impact and transform pervasive gender inequalities globally, efforts must transcend local scales and become integrated into national policy processes.

This document stems from Rwanda's National Revised Gender Policy (2021), providing national-level guidelines to engage men in gender- transformative approaches for gender equality and women's empowerment across various thematic areas.

1.1. Historical background

The global process of considering engaging men in the field of gender equality began in 1979, when the United Nations General Assembly adopted the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women

(CEDAW). CEDAW was the first international agreement mentioning men and women having equal responsibilities in family life and the need to transform social and cultural gender norms to eliminate stereotyped gender roles (Article 5).

In the 1980s and 1990s, a few programmes started engaging men and questioning harmful masculinities in the United States and in different Latin American countries, mainly to prevent GBV and prevent the spread of HIV/Aids (Glinski et al., 2018).

Another milestone is the 1995 Fourth World Conference on Women in Beijing. The Beijing Platform for Action marked a concerted shift in the international discourse towards actively acknowledging and engaging men and boys as an integral part of achieving gender equality, mainly in education, parenting, paid and unpaid care work, Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR), and GBV.

Following Beijing, a growing number of feminist men's groups in different parts of the world (including Africa) started encouraging men and boys to reconsider traditional and harmful notions of masculinities to promote positive behaviors, particularly in the field of GBV prevention and SRHR. This approach started gaining particular momentum and funding in 2000, and in 2004, the United Nations Commission on the Status of Women (CSW) began examining men and boys' role in achieving gender equality as one of its priority themes. In the same year, the Men Engage Alliance was founded as the global network of organizations and United Nations agencies working with boys and men to promote gender equality. Several regional networks were also created, including country networks in diverse parts of the world (North America, the Caribbean, Latin America, Africa, South Asia, and Europe).

In Rwanda, the Rwanda Men's Resource Centre (RWAMREC), a local NGO, played a pioneering role in introducing the approach of engaging men and boys in the country's gender equality efforts, in collaboration with CARE International in Rwanda. MIGEPROF largely supported the implementation of successful and tested models to engage men and boys in violence prevention, such as Indashyikirwa (See Box 2), working closely with them. Rwanda became a HeForShe country champion in 2015, when His Excellency President Paul Kagame was selected among the ten HeForShe global champions. This demonstrated globally Rwanda's commitment to involving men in promoting gender equality. Rwanda was the first African country to host the Men Engage Global Symposium in 2015, which brought together global stakeholders to exchange knowledge, share best practices, and strengthen the movement for gender equality.

Over the years, in collaboration with RWAMREC and various partners and with the support of the Rwandan government, Rwanda has made significant progress in promoting positive masculinities and engaging men in gender equality efforts. This is aligned with global and regional agreements ratified by Rwanda, as well as with different national policies and laws, as presented in the following paragraphs.

1.2. Policy alignment

1.2.1. Global and regional policy framework

The National Men Engage Transformative Strategy for Gender Equality represents an operationalization of different international agreements on gender equality that

have been ratified by the Government of Rwanda: notably, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948), the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (1979), the Beijing Platform for Action (1995), and the Sustainable Development Goals (2015). At the regional level, the strategy is also aligned with the Maputo Protocol (2003) and the Solemn Declaration on Gender Equality in Africa (2004). Additionally, the Government of Rwanda endorsed the East African Community Gender Policy, the Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA) Gender Policy, the African Union Gender Policy, the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, and the African Union's Agenda 2063.

1.2.2. National Policy and Legal Framework

The Government of Rwanda has made tremendous achievements in gender equality through the alignment of national priorities, policies, and laws to ensure equitable and gender-responsive development.

In terms of the legal framework, the Republic of Rwanda's 2003 Constitution (amended in 2023) prohibits any type of discrimination, including that based on sex (Art 16). With respect to women specifically, the Constitution allocates at least 30% of positions in all decision-making organs to women. As a result, women's representation in government (both the central and decentralized levels), and the private sector has significantly improved.

Rwanda Vision 2050, which intends for Rwanda to achieve upper-middle-class status by 2035 and high-income status by 2050, promotes a model of inclusive development, which aims at supporting gender equality, alongside pro-poor interventions, unity, and solidarity. Gender and family promotion are also one of the cross-cutting areas of the first and Second National Strategy of Transformation (NST), which sets out the plan to achieve Vision 2050 (2017-2024).

Furthermore, Rwanda has enacted legislation to promote gender equality and women's empowerment in planning and budgeting procedures, matrimonial regimes, donation and succession, land access, and the prevention and punishment of GBV.

The National Transformative Strategy Engaging Men for Gender Equality Promotion responds specifically to one of the policy actions identified in the newly revised National Gender Policy (2021) (5.1.1), which recommends to 'develop a National strategy/program to ensure that men and boys are effectively engaged in gender- related interventions across sectors, with more focus on the private sector.' This strategy is meant to specifically fill the gap identified by the policy with respect to the 'operationalisation of male engagement in gender promotion'.

Its emphasis on norm transformation is also meant to address policy action n. 4.1.1 ('identify map and address persistent negative cultural norms, gender stereotypes and practices affecting the principles of gender equality and equity'). Finally, given the strong focus that the Strategy has on the redistribution of unpaid care work at the household level, it also intends to respond to policy priority n. 4.1.3 ('Engage men for increased participation in domestic chores to allow women to participate more in other productive activities).

Ultimately, MIGEPROF believes that engaging men and boys will also contribute to other policy priorities advancing women's rights, such as accelerating women's economic empowerment (Priority 2), promoting gender equality in education, health and social protection (Priority 3) and in Increasing women's meaningful participation in leadership and decision-making positions (Priority 6).

2. A situational analysis of gender equality in Rwanda

Rwanda has made significant strides toward gender equality over the past two decades, becoming a global leader in women's political participation and showcasing progress in traditionally male-dominated sectors. This progress has been driven by national policies, women-led initiatives, and a strong commitment to gender equality, as evidenced by its high ranking in the Global Gender Gap Index. Despite these advancements, several gender gaps persist in areas such as economic empowerment, education, health, and political participation.

In the workforce, women's labor force participation lags behind that of men, with notable disparities between married women and men, as well as between women and men in formal versus informal sectors.

While gender parity in education has been achieved at the primary and secondary levels, women remain underrepresented in tertiary education and vocational training, particularly in the fields of Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics (STEM). In healthcare, while contraceptive use has increased among married women, young unmarried women still face significant barriers, and there are gaps in HIV knowledge and testing. The health sector also continues to struggle with gender-based violence (GBV), affecting more women and girls.

In terms of political participation, women's involvement in local governance and the private sector remains limited. Women hold fewer leadership roles at the regional level, and their presence in business management is disproportionately in small and micro enterprises.

Another critical issue is the disproportionate burden of unpaid care work on women, particularly in rural areas, which affects their ability to participate equally in the workforce and political life. Women spend significantly more time on household care activities, limiting their opportunities for economic and educational advancement.

These ongoing gender disparities are largely rooted in deep-seated gender norms and power imbalances that persist across social spheres, including in the household, schools, and workplaces. To achieve true gender equality, interventions must go beyond merely achieving parity in numbers and focus on challenging these norms and power dynamics. Engaging both men and boys alongside women and girls in the effort for transformation is essential for creating lasting change.

5. Rationale for the Transformative Men Engage Strategy

In light of the identified areas for improvement mentioned earlier, and their linkage with gender norms and roles that are deeply ingrained in the Rwandan society, it becomes of paramount importance to engage men and boys in the process of transforming patriarchal masculinities and further advancing gender equality and women's empowerment.

In Rwanda, despite the progressive laws highlighted in the previous section, in most cases, men still yield power as heads of household, in the community, and as religious leaders. Perpetration of GBV, as well as sexual harassment, is disproportionately committed by men.

In public and private associations and spheres of influence, the majority of decision-making positions are held by men. In addition to that, men control the majority of resources at the household, community, and national levels. Strategic partnerships between women and men are needed to ensure that men, at a minimum, do not become obstacles to women's and girls' access to resources and to participation in decision-making. Given that men hold positions of power in society, engaging them can also promote normative change via their influence.

Given the emphasis that Rwanda has put on advancing women's empowerment and participation in different spaces, it is important to make sure that empowered women and girls do not find themselves in a society that is not ready to receive them. If this happens, they might still be excluded from managing resources or even unintentionally be put more at risk of GBV at the household or community level. Engaging men and boys as allies is part of the process of creating a conducive environment for women's and girls' empowerment.

In addition to that, gender stereotypes in societies have negative consequences or costs for men too (e.g., suppression of emotions to stay 'in control, the absence of nurturing relationships with children, exposure to many health risks, poor health-seeking behaviors, and damage to interpersonal relations with women).

Therefore, men and boys are also co-beneficiaries or stakeholders in the process of advancing gender equality, as they will also largely benefit from healthier relationships with their partners, reduced burden and stress related to being the main/sole provider for the family, and better health outcomes, among other benefits.

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Lastly, since the objective of the Strategy is related to norm change and more equal power-sharing, for this to be possible there is a need to involve men and boys in the process, alongside women and girls, so that every party can play an active role in the process of transformation by challenging their own internalization of unequal gendered power dynamics, stereotypes, and by actively working to dismantle them out in the world too.

4. Strategic framework: objectives, outcomes and indicators

The overarching objective of the National Transformative Strategy Engaging Men and Boys for Gender Equality Promotions is to promote the engagement of men and boys in transforming gender norms in order to advance gender equality and support women's and girls' empowerment. The strategy-specific objectives are aligned with the three strategic thematic areas and with the three pillars of NST1. They are:

1. To enhance equitable social norms through promoting positive masculinities in education, health, and GBV prevention (social inclusion/NST1 social transformation);
2. To boost the economic well-being of women and girls at both individual and household levels by fostering positive masculinities, with a focus on economic empowerment and climate justice/economic transformation.
3. To strengthen women's effective political participation and decision-making by advancing positive masculinities, aimed at transformative governance.

The table below further articulates the strategic outcomes and the indicators under each strategic objective. It is important to highlight that the ultimate success of the Strategy will be seen through women's experienced outcomes, to assess whether relevant initiatives resulted in improved empowerment for women and girls.
However, since the majority of the indicators will be measured for both sexes, the direct benefits of increased gender equality in men's and boys' lives will also be assessed. Finally, measuring shifts in women's, men's, boys', and girls' gender-related behaviors and attitudes under each outcome is also recommended, as a way of tracking progressive change at the individual level, and of understanding the link with wider norm-change.

STRATEGIC OBJECTIVE 1	To enhance equitable social norms through promoting positive masculinities in education, health, and GBV prevention
Strategic Outcome 1.1	An increased percentage of women and girls, enjoy a life free from violence due to engaging men and boys on GBV prevention

Outcome Indicators	Prevalence of GBV among women, girls, men and boys in all its forms Attitudes towards gender norms in intimate relationships (GEM Scale) Number of couples formalizing their union
Strategic outcome 1.2	Women's and girls' level of education increases across all course options thanks to programming on positive masculinities
Outcome indicators	Number of women and girls completing tertiary education Number of women and girls joining STEM at tertiary level Attitudes towards girls' and women's education
Strategic outcome 1.3	Increased positive SRHR health-seeking behaviors of women, girls, men and boys
Outcome indicators	Number of youth aged 15-24 accessing SRHR services and products (contraceptives, HIV testing) Number of girls 15-19 who are pregnant with their first child or who have given birth Male accompaniment of women to ANC related services (all 4 visits)
Strategic Outcome 1.4	Men and boys are increasingly involved in unpaid care work related tasks
Outcome Indicators	Average hours per week spent on unpaid care work (both men and women) Attitudes towards male involvement in unpaid care work

STRATEGIC OBJECTIVE 2	To improve the economic welfare of women and girls at the individual and household levels through the promotion of positive masculinities
Strategic Outcome 2.1	Increased and sustained livelihoods for women and girls due to EMB in women's and girls' economic empowerment
Outcome Indicators	Number of women/girls who establish and expand sustainable businesses Number of women/girls accessing decent jobs Attitudes towards women and girls in paid work
Strategic Outcome 2.2	Improved women and girls' access to and utilization of formal financial services due to EMB in women's and girls' economic empowerment
Outcome Indicator	Number of women and girls accessing formal financial services Number of women and girls owning a saving account Attitudes towards women and girls' financial autonomy
STRATEGIC OBJECTIVE 3	To enhance women's meaningful political participation and decision-making through the promotion of positive masculinities
Strategic Outcome 3.1	Women and girls' representation in decision-making positions increases across all levels and sectors due to EMB in positive masculinity
Outcome Indicator	Number of women and girls in government leadership positions at all levels Number of women and girls in top management position within the private sector
Strategic Outcome 3.2	Increased women's voice and participation in decision-making due to EMB engagement in positive masculinity and women's leadership
Outcome Indicator	Number of women and girls who are able to influence decisions at all levels Attitudes and supportive behaviors towards women and girls in leadership

Following the objectives of the Strategy, the next section will present more details about the Strategy Intervention Logic, illustrating the approach proposed, the Theory of Change (ToC), and a more in-depth analysis of the proposed priority thematic areas.

5. Strategy Intervention Logic

5.1. A gender transformative approach

The National Transformative Strategy Engaging Men and Boys for Gender Equality Promotion intends to guide all national stakeholders in gender equality towards the adoption of what is called "a transformative process of gender mainstreaming".

For the process to be transformative, the Strategy intends to provide a framework for engaging boys and men, not just by making them aware of women's and girls' rights in the Law, but by addressing their roles in transforming many aspects of masculine behaviours, attitudes, representations and social relations, as well as wider structural forces and relations that create and sustain patriarchal or harmful forms of masculinities. To be able to do that, the Strategy recommends interventions situated towards the right end of the gender continuum (Gender Transformative, See Fig 1)— which invite participants to critically reflect on, challenge and redefine existing gender norms and unequal power dynamics between men, women, boys and girls. In particular, the Strategy recognizes that transforming harmful attitudes and roles associated to patriarchal masculinities is a crucial element in reconstructing more equal gender relations.

Solutions that reinforce gender inequalities through the use of gender norms, roles, and stereotypes for the programme to achieve its objectives	Solutions that maintain a status quo and fail to recognize or address gender norms, roles, and stereotypes, and thus, support gender inequality	Solutions that carefully consider gender issues and work within existing gender norms to address the exclusion of women; sometimes referred to as 'gender- smart' design	Solutions that directly aim to transform power dynamics and structures that maintain gender inequalities; these go beyond the symptoms of gender inequality to address the norms, attitudes, behaviours, and social systems that underlie them

Figure 2. A continuum for gender-transformative design

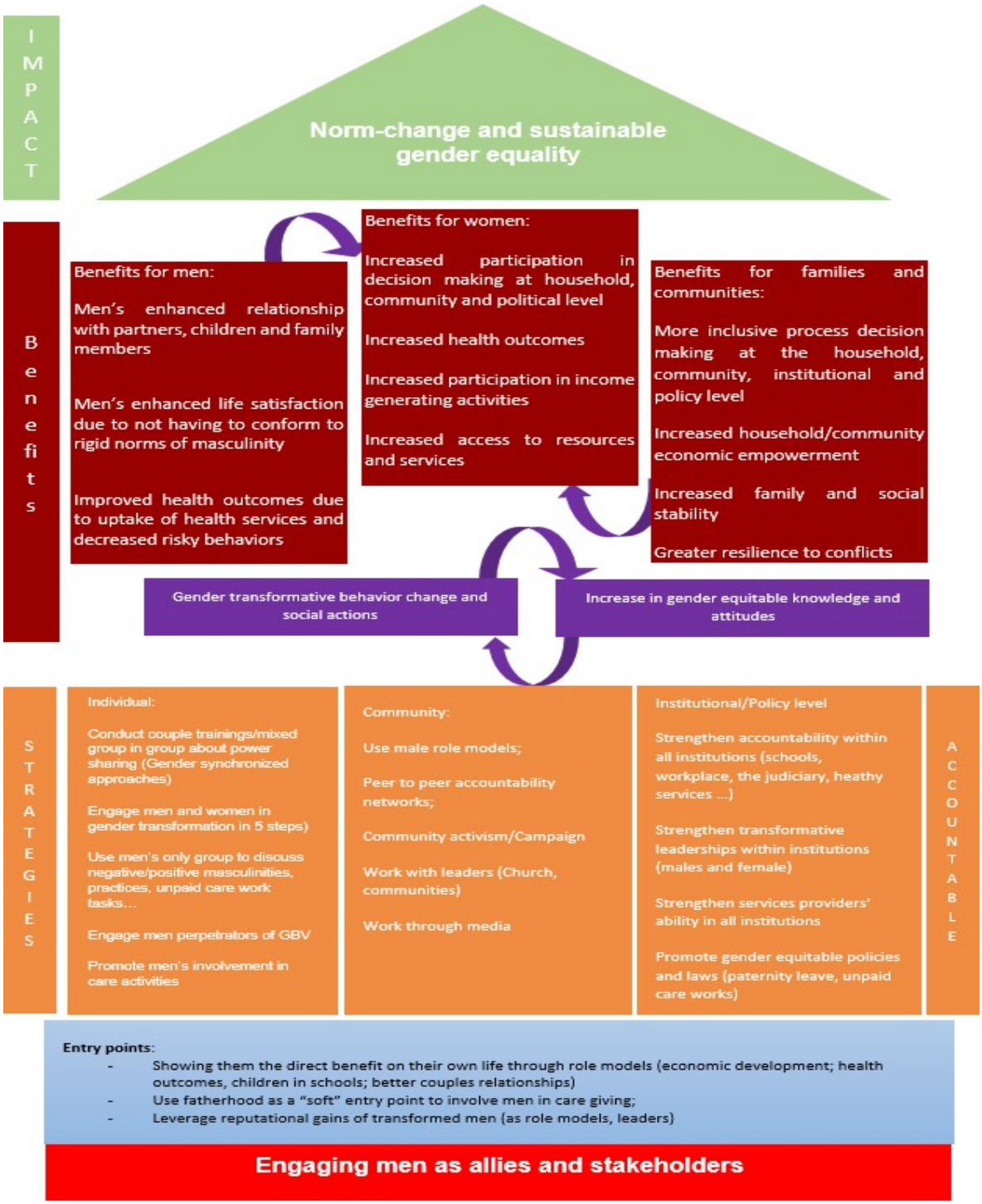
While engaging men and boys in transforming gender norms remains the core objective of the strategy, it is important to acknowledge that gender transformative work takes a long time and cannot be seen as a "quick fix" to bridge the identified gaps in a short time. A combination of gender-sensitive initiatives, which aim at solving immediate issues that women and girls might face, and longer-term gender transformative actions

for deep and long-term change is recommended. For instance, while engaging men at scale in unpaid care work is definitely a long-term solution that is likely to transform gender norms and roles over generations, it is also important to keep strengthening the available care infrastructure and services at the local level. This will ensure that – while working towards redistribution of the burden of unpaid care work at the household level – women are supported within their communities with free childcare services, to be able to work outside their homes

Figure 3. EMB Strategy Theory of Change, adapted from Glinski et al. 2018

The ToC above details the way in which engaging men and boys (in a gender transformative way) will contribute to positive outcomes for men/boys, the community/society at large, and women and girls themselves (red boxes). The reason why the men's and the communities' boxes are linked with the women's and girls' is that men/boys and communities that benefit from

gender equality will in turn, create a conducive environment for women's and girls' empowerment. The three combined outcome levels will then lead to sustainable gender equality (impact).



The orange boxes present some of the recommended norm-change strategies to promote positive masculinities and challenge gender norms, at the individual, community, and institutional or policy level. The ToC acknowledges that change needs to happen across all levels to be sustainable.

The vertical box indicates that such initiatives need to be accountable to women's rights groups and other social justice movements. It is important that the work done to engage men and boys keeps centering women and girls' needs and voices in the field of programming for gender equality.

The purple boxes show that the proposed norm-changing interventions will aim at transforming behaviors and gender-related knowledge and attitudes. The two aspects (behaviors and attitudes) mutually reinforce each other and can happen in any order: in some cases, increased positive knowledge and attitudes can lead to behavior change, while in other cases, behaviors can first change and attitudes might adjust at a later stage.

The light blue box below shows some of the possible entry points for the interventions to be able to effectively engage boys and men, and to overcome strategically men's and/or boys' resistance or lack of interest/disengagement in the GBV prevention. Using an emphasis on benefits for men and boys themselves as an entry point means that a gender equality program should strategically try to appeal to them in order to engage them meaningfully in a journey that ultimately is meant to produce a conducive and supportive environment for women and girls, while at the same time increasing men's and boys' well-being through their own internal transformation and interiorization of more equitable attitudes and behaviors. It is indeed important that this emphasis on the benefits for men should not, however, be interpreted as a means of reinforcing their position.
Lastly, the red box on the bottom suggests that gender transformative interventions can choose to engage men either as allies to women and girls' empowerment or as co-beneficiaries/stakeholders. Engaging men as allies means to engage them as individuals who understand the benefits of gender equality for women, and for the society at large, who play an active role to support women and girls and who use their influence and position to advocate for what is right. Engaging them as co-beneficiaries means going beyond an instrumental perspective, serving solely the needs of women and girls, by reaching a consensus that men and boys will benefit too from increased gender equality and positive masculinities.

5.3. Accountability

Higher standards of accountability in engaging men and boys are needed to create balance with the objective of centering women and girls under the umbrella of gender equality programming. The Strategy seeks to balance the

advancing women's own empowerment.

The key challenge here is to engage men positively and promote the idea that men can be agents of change while holding them accountable for acknowledging their participation in the ongoing struggle for women's rights. They should actively collaborate with organizations and movements led by women and girls.In terms of being responsive to demands for improved accountability, men and boys must acknowledge that privilege and power within relationships, and overall sensitivity to power, are key to upholding accountability.

5.4. The priority thematic areas

The priority thematic areas under this National Strategy include social inclusion, economic empowerment, climate justice, and transformative governance. These areas link to NST1 pillars and have been aligned with the existing areas for improvement in various sectors and sub-sectors identified in the situational analysis above. The following description of thematic areas articulates some of the relevant root causes of the identified gaps, in terms of gender norms and power dynamics. Interventions that adopt a gender-transformative approach and engage men and boys can help Rwanda bridge these gaps and make significant strides toward achieving gender equality.

5.4.1. Social Inclusion

The social inclusion thematic area focuses on the sub-sectors of education, health, SGBV, care work, and fatherhood. Programming within the social inclusion area is particularly key, as it also supports outcomes within economic empowerment and governance. For example, engaging men in unpaid care work and in GBV prevention will also support women's and girls' economic empowerment, as well as women's and girls' leadership and participation in decision-making.

Education

The situational analysis has indicated that significant progress has been made in Rwanda on girls' enrollment in primary and secondary schools, even though this changes at the tertiary level, where fewer female students than males graduate from university (MINEDUC, 2022). Existing research indicates that the gendered social expectations imposed on girls and young women significantly influence their educational experience. This can be explained by the fact that girls and young women are still expected to perform the bulk of regular household tasks and chores, including taking care of younger siblings, which can result in limited

secondary school. Some of them will enroll at a private university later, with the economic support of their husbands (Rubagiza et al. 2022). In addition to that, evidence has shown that girls and young women can face sexual harassment in educational settings, both in secondary schools and in higher learning institutions, mostly involving requests for sexual favors in exchange for better grades. (Transparency International Rwanda 2022). This might severely impact girls' school attendance and performance, as well as affect their physical and mental health.

Unwanted pregnancies among adolescent girls result most of the time in them dropping out of school (CLADHO 2016, GER 2020). Despite the existence of return to school policies for adolescent mothers, the life conditions and the stigma they face within the school and the community make it actually very difficult for them to rejoin education and complete their studies (Gatsinzi 2022). Families might refuse to pay their school fees again, they might opt for a cohabitation with their child's father, or, if rejected, they might end up living on their own while having to look for money daily, to sustain themselves and their child (GER 2020).

Finally, the fact that girls are still a minority in TVET and STEM options, can be explained by the influence that gender has on individuals' subject choice, i.e. the fact that boys and girls tend to choose or perform better in those subjects respectively seen as traditionally male (Science related, construction, mechanics…) and female (Arts and humanities, culinary arts, hairdressing).

Alongside investing in girls' education, SRHR and leadership, there is need to engage parents, boys, teachers, and educational staff, community members in gender transformative programs, in order to dismantle gendered stereotypes and roles which might limit boys' and girls' choices and girls' performance, and to prevent GBV and sexual harassment within education settings.

Health

Given its relational nature, the gender gaps in health identified in the situational analysis mostly refer to Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR), Harmful constructions of masculinities and negative gender norms, which can have detrimental consequences on men and boys themselves, as well as on women and girls, as their sexual partners (IPPF and UNFPA 2017). When men do not know their HIV positive status, for example, they are less likely to treat themselves and to practice safer sex, and thus much more likely to transmit HIV to their partners.

Moreover, power dynamics and gendered roles in the household can influence women's choices related to SRHR. Men might either want to have the final say in terms of the number of children, by imposing their views regarding birth spacing, or might get completely disengaged and leave the whole burden of family planning on the woman (Schwandt 2021). When it comes to maternal care specifically, the only formal involvement of men that is required is their presence during the first antenatal care session (ANC), when both partners get tested for HIV/Aids. Otherwise, men are rarely involved during ANC, delivery, postnatal care session (PNC), and also for the baby's vaccination or weight measurement (Tuyisenge et al. 2021). Their involvement is mainly in terms of providing financial support for transport and other health-related expenses. Among the youth, different pieces of qualitative research have shown that

unwanted pregnancies among adolescents are likely to be the result of coerced sex between a girl and an older boy (CLADHO 2016, GER 2020). Power relations, gendered expectations, as well as conservative attitudes towards the use of contraceptives among adolescents, strongly shape boys' and girls' interactions related to sex and SRH. Boys are prone to believe that a girl's 'N0' should be turned into a 'YES' by insisting, or that a girl who visits them at home is automatically consenting to sex. To this must be added the fact that girls tend not to have the confidence to set boundaries, to access contraceptives, or to negotiate their use with boys (Gupta et al. 2021, GER 2020).

Lastly, in Rwanda as in other contexts, social constructions of dominant forms of masculinities might also negatively influence men's and boys' behaviors, making them more likely to consume alcohol and tobacco, or less prone to seek professional medical health for the different health problems they might face (Uwimana et al. 2023).

The health sector is one of the key and most entrenched sectors for male engagement. Setting a target to engage men as partners within health interventions—such as family planning programs, reproductive health interventions, and HIV/AIDS prevention— is essential to achieve better health outcomes for everyone, as well as gender equity and equality. Men need to be actively involved in health programs to support sustainable household health.

Key initiatives should focus on increasing the use of available contraceptive methods, promoting birth spacing, and improving overall sexual and reproductive health outcomes. Additionally, involvement in broader maternal and child health programs is essential. The consequences of gender inequality in terms of health - mental, physical, and physiological - must also be linked to gender-based violence, of which women and girls are often the primary victims;

Strategies to end GBV must engage men and boys, alongside women and girls, for two main reasons: first, the perpetrators of GBV are overwhelmingly male, and, secondly, the root causes of GBV are found within gender norms and unequal power dynamics between men and boys and women and girls. Dominant notions of masculinities can see violence either as an intrinsic aspect of "being a man", or at least a legitimate response to perceived threats to masculine identities and power (Heilman, Barker, 2018). However, gender transformative work is needed with both genders, as national data show that acceptance of GBV is still widespread among women: 50% of Rwandan women still agree that wife beating can be justifiable under at least one circumstance out of five (vs only 18% of men) (DHS 2020). This clearly shows that patriarchal gender norms and negative stereotypes can be deeply internalized even by those who are most affected by them.

Moreover, it is important to acknowledge that men make up the majority of individuals within the GBV response mechanisms, such as the RIB, the Police, doctors, and the military. Working with them is important to facilitate a victim's reporting experience that does not cause further harm, including mitigating the risk of victim blaming and other forms of continued violence against the victims/survivors.

Therefore, addressing men and boys' role in violence perpetration, redefining masculinities and challenging negative gender norms and expectations are key to preventing GBV from occurring and to responding to it.

Unpaid Care Work and Positive Parenting

Despite unpaid care work being essential for the social and economic well-being of individuals, families, and societies (it contributes to GDP), it often goes unrecognized, and it is almost exclusively carried out by women and girls.

Indicators show that women and girls in Rwanda dedicate way more time to unpaid care work-related tasks than men and boys (LFS 2022, Un Women 2022). This happens because there are still deeply ingrained social norms suggesting that – while men are expected to be their household's breadwinners – women are expected to be entirely responsible for household duties, childcare, caring for the sick, and for elders as well. Girls are actively taught different skills related to unpaid care work, and they are consistently exposed to females performing domestic chores since they are born. According to UNWOMEN, on the contrary, more than 60% of men have never observed their fathers or other men in the household preparing meals, cleaning the house, or washing clothes (UNWomen 2022).

Parenting roles in Rwanda are also strongly gendered: while the father is the one

tasks related to caregiving, including feeding, taking the child to the hospital, soothing the baby, carrying him/her, bathing, changing the diaper and so on, with the help of other female family members or helpers.

It has been widely proven that their involvement in unpaid care work drastically reduces the amount of time that women and girls can spend on other activities, including education, income generation, political participation, as well as leisure. This has consequences on their education and career advancements, as well as their mental and physical health. Specifically, the "mental load"—the psychological burden of managing domestic and educational responsibilities—can result in significant mental and physical exhaustion. Additionally, women and girls who are unable to meet societal expectations for unpaid care work are more likely to experience gender-based violence within their own homes. (Un Women 2022).

Interestingly, while in recent years, women's participation in the Rwandan workforce has increased, men's participation in care work has remained stagnant (NISR, 2022). This has created an increased burden for women, who have to juggle multiple roles between their paid employment and their unpaid care work responsibilities at the household and community levels. Such expectations are so deeply ingrained that men who participate in domestic chores are likely to be mocked or laughed at within their communities (and called inganzwa) and their wives accused of "having bewitched them" (Kapur 2021).

Significant investments have been made in Rwanda to reduce the burden of unpaid care work through the construction of physical infrastructure and the introduction of labour-saving consumable goods, to reduce time spent by women and girls on such tasks. Also, enhancing social care service infrastructure, like community-based ECD, meant transforming some of the domestic unpaid care work into paid social care work (Un Women 2018). However, due to the relational and personal nature of unpaid care work, there is an ultimate limit to how much care work can be redistributed to the paid market, and an important amount of it will remain in the form of unpaid domestic chores.

Therefore, programs engaging men and boys are strongly encouraged to have a specific focus on caregiving and to integrate unpaid care work among their objectives. A fairer distribution between men, women, boys, and girls at the household level will have a positive impact on women's economic empowerment, leadership, health, and education.

Additionally, men who engage in unpaid care work are less likely to commit GBV (Barker et al., 2012). Engaging men in caregiving has been proven to have different benefits for men themselves, such as developing deeper relationships with their children and partners which in turn lead to more stable and prosperous households, and better mental health (ibid). Moreover, it also positively influences children: by being exposed to the model of a present and caring father, children are more likely to develop positive gender attitudes and

5.4.2. Economic Empowerment and Climate

Justice: Employment and Job Creation

To increase women's access to economic opportunities, Rwanda's development The strategy has set a priority of creating 1.5 million decent and productive jobs, which will increase women's entrepreneurship and income-generation opportunities in the informal and formal labour markets. While more women have already entered the labour market in Rwanda and engaged in the production of goods and services in recent years, they are more likely to be unemployed, underutilized, or to be in the informal sector, which is characterized by more precarious, unstable, and lower income (LFS, 2022). This is mostly due to gender norms, stereotypes, and social expectations: women are mostly expected to prioritize family over their career development since, ultimately, men are the ones to provide financially. As much as the current Rwandan society encourages women to work, the burden of unpaid care work that comes with women's role as wives and mothers limits their time and energy to dedicate to job seeking and working, or to advance in their careers. This also shapes the experience of girls' transition from education to work, as well as their own aspirations. Once they complete their education, girls might want to prioritize getting married and having children over their careers. This translates to fewer girls/young women entering the labour force and/or entering it when older and less competitive.

Working with parents and people of both sexes in a gender-transformative way is therefore of paramount importance to address the gender stereotypes and power dynamics that still hold girls behind in their career development.

Sexual harassment is also a serious hindrance to girls entering (or staying) the labour force. Some studies have documented its existence during job-seeking, recruitment, and probation processes (TI-RW 2021). Engaging men in the workplace, as top leaders and co-workers, is also key to addressing such risks. Moreover, research also shows that, in a context characterized by strong gender inequality and the prevalence of patriarchal notions of masculinities, women's increased market-oriented economic activity might result in an increased risk of domestic violence (Désilets 2019).

Women's financial autonomy might be perceived by their husbands as a threat to their own role and power within the household and even result in enhanced conflict and violence between the spouses. Therefore, engaging men in initiatives aiming at promoting women's economic empowerment in a gender-transformative way is normally recommended as a good practice to avoid any unintended harm.

conflict and violence between the spouses. Therefore, engaging men in initiatives aiming at promoting women's economic empowerment in a gender-transformative way is normally recommended as a good practice to avoid any unintended harm.

Access to Finance

Although access to finance has increased for both women and men, boys and girls, a recent study shows that social norms limit women from accessing formal financial services and requesting loans (AFR 2022). When the collateral is a joint property with their partner, women are less likely than men to obtain permission from their partner to use it to obtain a loan from the bank to start or grow a business. Also, the social norm that women should prioritize family over business seems to particularly affect young women in rural areas: these women are more likely to use the income from the business to meet family needs rather than invest it to grow it. Therefore, in order to promote women's and girls' access to finance and women's business in general, there is a need not only to increase their financial literacy and skills but also to address the gender norms and power dynamics that still hold women back from developing their full entrepreneurial potential. In addition to that, engaging men and boys is of paramount importance to create a conducive environment for women and girls' entrepreneurs.

Climate Justice

A qualitative study carried out in Rwanda has revealed that unpredictable and severe seasonal variations and natural disasters, in particular floods, erosions, and droughts, are aggravating underlying gender inequalities between men and women, increasing incidences of SGBV, and enhancing socio-economic vulnerabilities for women and girls (Kvinna till kvinna 2022). In particular, the burden of unpaid care work has increased due to climate change. Collecting firewood and fetching water, traditionally women's tasks, take longer in cases of drought or natural disaster, but can also expose women and girls to increased risk of GBV. Reduced livelihoods and increased poverty due to climate change can lead to conflict in the household, increased GBV, and girls dropping out of school and getting married early.

Moreover, climate change can push men to migrate far away from their families in an attempt to look for income, and this might lead to an increased risk of STIs, including HIV/Aids, as well as increased poverty for women, who are left in the rural areas to provide for their children.Therefore, when designing interventions for emergency preparedness or response, it is important to engage men and boys, to mitigate the risk of GBV, and to ensure that women are supported by men in taking care of their own families in emergencies.

5.4.3. Transformative governance

Participation in leadership positions

Even though women's and girls' leadership has significantly increased in Rwanda, the situational analysis has shown that the percentage decreases at the local level, as well as within the private sector. A recent study has shown that women at the local level face different obstacles that prevent them from being able to take up leadership roles (Slegh et al. 2021).

The most significant issue is the burden of unpaid care work, which leads to time poverty and prevents them from dedicating sufficient time to political activities. In addition to this, some also face resistance from their husbands and their own families, as they might need to dedicate less time to the family and travel far to attend some meetings. Finally, due to the way they were socialized, women and girls feel less equipped

with some skills normally associated with leadership positions, such as speaking in public (ibid). This leads women and girls to a form of unconscious self-censorship, keeping them at a distance from spaces of political expression and leadership positions.

Within the private sector, women and girls in Rwanda are likely to face similar obstacles to women in other contexts. Their career advancement to the top leadership position is likely to encounter invisible barriers related to their gender (glass ceiling), such as being seen as less competitive because of being likely to get pregnant, and not being able to devote themselves entirely to the job compared to men.

Moreover, working mothers might also be facing similar obstacles (maternal wall), due to the burden of unpaid care work associated with childcare and related responsibilities, as well as being perceived as "less committed".

Finally, women and girls in the workplace are also likely to face sexual harassment by their superiors or colleagues (TI-RW 2021). Sexual harassment can seriously hinder women's well-being at the workplace as well as their career progression. It is therefore important to engage men as leaders within the public and the private sector, to support women's and girls' career development, by promoting flexible working arrangements, and gender-sensitive or transformative workplace guidelines, including policies and mechanisms to prevent and respond to sexual harassment.

Women's Voice and Participation in Decision-Making

In addition to increasing the number of women and girls in leadership roles, it's crucial to ensure that their voices are genuinely heard and have a meaningful impact. Their meaningful participation in decision-making processes is important at all levels, from the household to the community and the national political arena. While gender quotas in Rwanda might encourage gender balance in terms of numbers, gender norms still hold women back from leading or influencing decision-making processes, while reinforcing the idea that their presence is merely symbolic.

Gender stereotypes might prevent women from expressing themselves freely, for fear of being seen as bossy. Moreover, the burden of unpaid care work and the triple role that women leaders have to fulfill (as caregiver, provider, and leader), is likely to prevent them from being able to dedicate themselves to their leadership role as meaningfully as their male colleagues.

Engaging male allies in being able to discuss decisions with women, and also in using their influence to elevate women and women's voices in policy design, and in welcoming gender-related points within their agenda is important, in order to create a conducive environment for women's leadership. Redistributing unpaid care work more equally at the household level is crucial, in order to guarantee women's and girls' meaningful involvement in leadership and decision-making.

The next section will go into more detail about different specific implementation strategies and approaches that different stakeholders- both in the public and the private sector- are recommended to use to engage men and boys for gender equality at individual, household, community and policy level, and across the three main thematic areas, in order to support Rwanda to reach the strategic objectives.

6. Implementation approaches

6.1. Operational strategies

This section presents the suggested programmatic approaches and strategies to inform interventions and programs done by different stakeholders in different thematic areas, to engage men and boys to promote gender equality and women's empowerment. The first sub-paragraph presents the general strategic guiding principles, whereas the subsequent ones provide detailed approaches tailored to the three levels of the socio-ecological model—individual/households, community, and institution/policy—as well as specific thematic areas. The proposed strategies are inspired by existing best practices operating in the country, in the region, and at the global level.

6.1.1. Guiding principles

Engaging men and boys does not simply mean involving them. Their engagement should be done in a gender transformative way (See Box 1), which means through activities and initiatives that foster critical examination of gender norms and power dynamics, with the ultimate aim of changing negative gender norms and shifting unequal power dynamics. If men and boys are not engaged in a transformative way, but rather by reinforcing their traditional roles as protectors of women and girls (seen as victims) or breadwinners, there is a risk that even interventions designed with good intentions might result in enhancing negative gender stereotypes in the long-run.

Engaging men and boys through gender transformative programming implies promoting positive masculinities. Men and boys should be engaged in a process of deconstructing traditional and harmful notions of masculinities and adopting more positive, caring, nurturing, empathic, and equitable identities as men and boys. Adopting a gender-synchronized approach, programs and interventions should engage all genders in transforming social norms. This approach is crucial because traditional notions of masculinity are perpetuated by both sexes during socialization. Women and girls may reinforce these norms through their behaviors, pass them on to their children, or even challenge or mock men who deviate from traditional expectations. Gender-synchronized approaches involve working with men and boys, and women and girls, either

together in mixed groups or separately in different phases. In both scenarios, it's essential to offer safe spaces where individuals can discuss their experiences with gender norms and power dynamics separately. Additionally, creating opportunities for meaningful and safe cross-gender dialogue is important for fostering empathy and collaboration.

Promote programs that use long-term and multi-sectoral interventions across all levels of the socio-ecological model. Norm change is complex and requires time. While engaging individuals and couples in gender transformative sessions is a good way of promoting positive behavior change, such interventions are normally limited in scale and happen mostly at the individual/household level. The impact cannot be sustained if efforts are not extended to the wider community, as well as to the institutional and policy level.

Realistically, not every intervention can address all levels of engagement. However, projects should be designed to complement, build upon, and leverage existing efforts to achieve sustainable, long-term impact. Programs are encouraged to integrate: activities focused on changing individual behaviors and relationship dynamics between men and women; community-level initiatives aimed at shifting dominant social norms related to gender and violence; efforts to embed positive gender norms within institutions such as health, education, and law enforcement; and advocacy campaigns promoting national policies and laws that involve men and boys in gender equality and gender-based violence (GBV) prevention.

BOX 1. How to engage men and boys in a gender-transformative way

At the individual level, the Strategy proposes a five-step model for engaging men and boys through gender transformative initiatives.

STEP 1: The first step is to make men, boys, women, and girls understand that gender roles and stereotypes related to masculinities and femininities, as well as the inequalities existing between women, men, boys, and girls, are socially and historically constructed, and not naturally determined. It is the society that teaches us what it means to be a man and a woman, that creates a hierarchy between women and men, boys and girls, and it is also the society that rewards (or sanctions) individuals for conforming or not to gendered expectations. Understanding the difference between sex and gender, as well as the way gender is learned (and taught) through socialization throughout the life cycle of boys, girls, women, and men, is of paramount importance to understand that change is possible.

STEP 2: As a second step, it is important that men and boys understand deeply that the current status quo is detrimental and harmful to women and girls in society, in different ways: it constrains women's and girls' agency, opportunities, and human rights. It fuels GBV and places the burden of unpaid care work almost exclusively on the shoulders of girls and women, limiting the time they can dedicate to education, economic activities, or political participation.

STEP 3: Thirdly, boys and men should be invited to reflect on the costs (social, psychological, emotional) that

rigid ideas of masculinity can have on their own lives. It is important that men and boys have deeply understood the unequal impact of gender inequalities on the lives of women and girls, before starting this self-reflection exercise, to avoid the idea that gender inequalities negatively affect women and men, boys and girls in the same way.

Many men and boys have internalized and feel regular pressure to conform to the rigid, pervasive, and harmful social norms about masculinities in society as presented in media, societal values, and institutional structures. Men and boys rarely recognize that exploring, reflecting on, and deconstructing these norms can benefit them. Whereas not all common norms of masculinities are harmful, there are ample circumstances in which masculinities are strongly associated with risky behaviours—such as alcohol consumption, substance abuse, violent gang participation, or having multiple sexual partners—that can result in dangerous consequences for men and boys (Heilman & Barker, 2018). In addition, prevailing constructions of masculinities prescribe that the man is the provider and protector of the family. The inherent pressure this can place on some men and boys may lead them to aggressive behaviours, possibly to direct the focus away from their perceived sense of failure in not being able to meet the expectations of this role.

STEP 4: As a fourth step, men and boys should be made aware of the positive outcomes of gender equality not only for women and girls, but also for themselves, in order to promote the idea that it is in men and boys' best interest to support the empowerment of women and girls. Programmes should highlight that gender-equitable men will have better, closer relationships to their children and partners. Family dynamics offer other avenues for constructive male engagement. An emphasis on broadening norms related to fatherhood can be an effective entry point for. male engagement programming, as men and boys quickly realise the benefits and self-satisfaction that they derive from closer relationships with their children. As a result of taking on a greater role in caregiving, men and boys often become motivated to take on additional unpaid care work, participating actively in its redistribution within the household.

Similarly, men and boys will change their attitudes when they recognise the benefits that flow to the entire household (e.g., economic and health benefits) from having more equitable relationships. Additionally, while less likely to be persuasive in changing the attitudes of individual men and boys, male policymakers, and others in positions of influence may be moved by the recognition that current constructions, norms, and attitudes related to masculinities are costly.

STEP 5: Boys and men should not only be taught about the importance of adopting more gender equitable behaviours (. e.g: behaviours related to unpaid care work tasks or to joint planning with their wives) but- when possible- they should be given the opportunity to practice them in a safe space (during group session or at home with their partners). This would serve three purposes: it would allow them to acquire new practical skills that they might not have been socialized into; it would also help them acquire the confidence in performing them in front of others (men and women) by starting in a space where they would not be judged or laughed at; it would also give them a sense of the actual benefits that they would get from adopting them.

Please note that according to the type of intervention, the order of the 4 steps can change. For example, an intervention targeting men and boys specifically could decide to start with STEP 4, in order to capture their attention at first, by highlighting the positive outcomes of gender equality in their own lives. This could be followed by making them reflect on the negative outcomes of gender inequality on themselves (STEP 3) and on women and girls (STEP 2). The whole journey could be concluded with the optimistic acknowledgment that things can change as they are socially constructed and therefore can be challenged (STEP 1).

Encourage programs that offer persuasive incentives to men and boys to participate in advancing gender equality. Alongside positive outcomes for women and girls, programs are encouraged to also promote positive outcomes for men and boys, to make them realize that promoting gender equality and women's and girls' empowerment is also in their own interest. In such a way, men and boys will be fully on-board as stakeholders and agent of change in the process. It is important that interventions take time to show men and boys how rigid notions of masculinity can negatively impact their own lives (risky behaviours, exposure to stress, negative health outcomes, disconnection), without however passing the message that such consequences are comparable to the ones faced by women and girls.

Discernible benefits for men engaged in gender equality which can be presented as catalysts to incentivize men's participation could be the self-satisfaction derived from closer relationships with their spouse or children, increased family development, and decreased pressure due to their wives' contribution to family income, better health outcome for men due to the adoption of protective behaviours, among others.

Promote the scale-up of successful evidence-based gender transformative models already tested and evaluated in Rwanda through embedding them in the existing structures and systems. Rigorous evidence is available about the positive impacts of different existing gender transformative programs engaging men in Rwanda, in the field of GBV prevention and promotion of maternal, newborn and child-health (See Box 2). An iterative and staggered process towards the scale up of such models is recommended, in order to ensure that quality and fidelity are maintained at scale. In particular, it is strongly recommended to carry out a phase of testing and refinement of the model when embedded within government structures (in one setting), before roll-out.

Box 2: Two evidence-based successful models engaging men through couple trainings in Rwanda

Bandebereho: ('role model' in Kinyarwanda) works with men and couples with young children (<5) promote men's engagement in reproductive, maternal and newborn health, violence prevention, caregiving, and healthier couple relations. The intervention uses fatherhood as an entry point to promote men's participation as caring, non-violent, and supportive fathers and partners. Bandebereho takes a gender-transformative approach –meaning that participants critically question and reflect on gender norms, or the social expectations for women and men, and their impact on their roles as parents and partners. Participants are invited to attend up to 17 small group sessions of critical reflection, dialogue, and participatory activities that support men (and their partners) to learn, practice, and adopt more equitable attitudes and behavior related to parenting, care work, couple communication, and non-violent conflict resolution.

The pilot phase of Bandebereho (2013-2015) has been evaluated through 2 rounds of RCTs at 21 and 76 months after the intervention. Results of the RCTs have demonstrated that the approach is effective in promoting long-lasting positive impacts across a wide number of outcomes, including MNCH, SRH, GBV and VAC reduction, gender equality, parenting, and mental health (Doyle et al. 2018, Doyle et al. 2023). The program is implemented by RWAMREC and it is currently in its scale-up phase.

Indashyikirwa: ('agent of change' in Kinyarwanda), is a model designed to reduce levels of intimate partner violence, as well as to improve the response to survivors. The programme shifts attitudes and behaviours at the individual and relationship levels, as well as transforms wider social norms that tolerate violence and underpin inequalities between men and women. The model has four components, including a 21-session participatory training curriculum for couples; community-based activism (inspired by SASA! model) led by a subset of individuals who completed the couples' curriculum and received ten additional days of activist training; direct support to survivors of GBV through women's safe spaces; training and engagement of opinion leaders. A cluster randomized controlled trial of the couples' component showed that Indashyikirwa reduced both women's reported experiences and men's reported perpetration of violence (Dunkle et al. 2020). The programme also led to reduced acceptability of violence, depression, and interpersonal conflict, as well as increased communication, trust, self-efficacy, and household earnings, as well as reduced violence against children. Indashyikirwa has been successfully implemented by CARE Rwanda, through RWAMREC and Rwanda Women's network (RWN).

Carefully monitor and evaluate gender transformative interventions engaging men, and apply timely course correction to prevent unintentional harm to women, girls, and also men and boys within the communities. Gender transformative programming in communities is a type of engagement that deeply questions hierarchies and power dynamics within the groups involved and even in the communities at large in which the change is happening. In particular, it is important to monitor how the change of behaviours at the individual level is received within communities and make sure that it does not cause unintended harm in the form of violence or backlash.

Promote the creation of a community of practice or a learning platform where to share evidence and practices among stakeholders engaging men and doing gender transformative work. Knowledge-share among practitioners, existing networks engaging men and boys at the national level (RWAMNET), donors, government, women's rights and women-led organizations, as well as community leaders and members is encouraged, in order to build on the experiences of what works and what does not, and ensure mutual accountability.

6.1.2. Individual and household level strategies

Working with individuals through in-depth long-term gender transformative initiatives has been proven to be effective in promoting positive impacts for individual men and boys, women and girls, and couples, across a number of outcomes, including health, GBV prevention, economic empowerment, decision-making, and others. The following paragraph details some of the best practices, alongside some suggested innovations, that stakeholders can consider applying in their work at the individual and household levels. Some of the proposed strategies apply across all three thematic areas, while others are specific to one or two of them.

Across all thematic areas:Engage men and boys across the life cycle, and keep adapting the approach to age and life transition. Engaging adolescent boys early on is likely to yield a stronger and more enduring impact. Adolescent boys are at an age where their attitudes and beliefs with respect to gender norms are still developing, as well as their masculine identities.

They are therefore more likely to learn and adopt positive and more equitable behaviors than the older generations. This change will positively reflect both in their current life as boys and in their relationships with girls, as well as in their future lives as adult husbands and fathers. Men could also be engaged as husbands and fathers later in life and supported to develop more equitable relationships with their wives, as well as closer relationships with their children. Displaying positive, equitable, and caring behaviors at the family level will also positively impact children's own attitudes and behaviors with respect to gender equality. A child who grows up in a healthy and equitable setting is more likely to develop positive and equitable behaviours toward the opposite sex as he/she grows up. It is also important not to leave out pre-primary and primary school-aged children through parenting programs, but also through involving community-based and school educators,including male engagement in unpaid care work as a component of all initiatives engaging men and boys at all levels, across all thematic areas.

Engaging men in caregiving and in unpaid care work has been proven to be an effective approach to reducing GBV, improving couple relationships and equitable decision-making, and supporting women's and girls' economic empowerment and their participation in politics and leadership in general. This approach is particularly effective in fostering men's and boys' empathy towards women and girls, and in producing a visibly positive alternative to traditional, dominant masculinity (a man or a boy who shares more equitably tasks that are perceived as "for women and girls").

Social inclusion thematic area:
Working with couples through group education sessions around GBV prevention is an approach that can yield positive results. Curricula in these programs allow participants to reflect on their own experiences of power and violence, as well as on the costs of rigid norms related to masculinities and femininities. In addition to the gender transformative components, they also teach couples skills on how to manage triggers to GBV, including alcohol abuse, sex, and financial management at home. Models can involve couples who live in conflict/violence alongside couples who live in peace and who can act as role models and group motivators.

Working directly with male perpetrators to change their behaviors and attitudes towards women and girls is a common approach to address, mitigate, and prevent GBV from re-occurring. This can be done in group education sessions or in one-to-one counseling sessions.

Testing gender transformative approaches, promoting positive masculinities targeting male inmates or men and boys in rehabilitation centers, is also recommended, particularly during the last months before release. The idea is that such gender conversations will support their integration back into their families and communities, and in particular in re-establishing a relationship with the women and girls in their lives. Such interventions should also aim at redefining masculinity to decrease the uptake of risky and violent behaviours, while supporting individual capacity to manage and prevent relapse.

Targeting young men and boys who have grown up in violent homes can be an effective strategy to break the cycle of violence. It is known that children who were exposed to violence in different ways while growing up are more

reflection on their own experience of violence, as well as on masculinities and gender norms are encouraged.

Engaging men as fathers of young children or as expectant fathers has been proven to be very impactful across a wide range of outcomes, including gender equality, health, GBV and violence against children, parenting, healthy relationships, SRHR and MNCH, and participation in unpaid care work (see Box 2). Fatherhood is one of the most effective entry points for involving men in caregiving, gender equality, and GBV prevention, by proposing alternative forms of masculinities that imply a more equitable distribution of tasks and decision-making. Engaging men as fathers has the advantage of presenting very tangible benefits to men, like developing closer and deeper relationships with their children as well as ensuring their own children's well-being.

Moreover, it also provides a non-confrontational way of engaging men in gender equality, as men are engaged primarily as fathers or fathers to be and not only as partners. It is also likely to positively impact the gender related attitudes and behaviors of their own children, especially their sons, who are more likely to have positive attitudes towards gender equality and sharing unpaid care work-related tasks. Engaging men as fathers can be done in different ways, including couple training in group education sessions or through the creation of male-only fathers' school/safe spaces at the community level, where fathers or expectant fathers can discuss about their involvement in caregiving and also practice newly acquired practical skills in unpaid care work (carrying, feeding a child, bathing him/her…).

In urban settings specifically, shorter-term engagement sessions with expectant male employees in the months that precede paternal leave can be considered as a strategy to motivate them to use positively the time of their leave, by engaging in activities finalized to bonding with the child and supporting the mother.Engaging men as fathers of adolescent boys and girls can also be strategic in positively informing their children's attitudes and behaviours related to gender, as well as a wider range of outcomes related to girls' and boys' education and SRHR, among others.

Programs working with teen mothers should also consider engaging adolescent boys and young men as fathers. Too often, cases of early pregnancies negatively impact girls, who are likely to drop out of school, face rejection from their parents/relatives, and experience issues related to mental health, as well as poverty and deprivation. This is likely to negatively affect the child once born. Boys and young men responsible for the pregnancy (as well as the boys' families) are likely not to get involved in the girl's and in their children's (or grandchildren's) lives, and thus contribute to their isolation and insecurity. Programs working with teen mothers are also encouraged to engage their children's fathers to promote a wider and positive understanding of their role as parents and encourage the establishment of positive relationships between the families, the parents, and the child. In such programs, when possible, it is recommended to also include parents of both the teen mother and fathers, to support the creation of a positive and supportive environment through parent and child positive communication (PAC).

The Strategy encourages engaging adolescent boys in positive SRHR gender transformative programs and initiatives, under the argument that

starting young is essential and allows interventions to capitalize on the moment when young men's and women's views on gender and sexuality are just forming. Discussing SRHR, including access to services and contraceptive options, should integrate a reflection around how gender norms and power dynamics might affect the individual health of boys and girls, as well as romantic and sexual relationships between them. Engaging young boys in discussion around their own power/privileges with respect to girls and on the specific topic of consent is of particular importance to promote more equitable and healthier relationships among them.

Engaging boys and young men in school should also be reinforced. Education settings are particularly conducive to engaging boys and girls in gender transformative conversations. Engaging boys in schools could result into a reduction of sexual harassment and sexual violence affecting girls, and in the reduction of unwanted teenage pregnancies.

Moreover, engaged boys are also most likely to alleviate the burden of unpaid care work on girls, to report or speak out against any form of violence directed against girls, and to support girls in their choice of prioritizing their educational attainment over marriage and children.

When engaging men and boys in schools, content and approaches should be tailored to the age of the students targeted. Gender transformative playful activities and role plays, as well as storytelling and songs, can be recommended for pre-primary and primary children, while SRHR conversations and leadership training for boys and girls can be used at the secondary level, as well as within universities.

Economic empowerment and climate justice:

Rather than making them a standalone, consider integrating Men Engage components across programs promoting women's economic empowerment, including programs promoting saving, access to financial services, and entrepreneurship. This should be done to ensure that the initiatives result in increased women's autonomy and agency and do not enhance the likelihood of GBV in the household. Such programs should engage men either through all-male groups or as couples to inform men about the economic benefits that their partner's economic empowerment will bring to the household, to reflect on how financial decision-making happens at home and how to make it more equitable, and also to share unpaid care work more equally, to ensure that women have enough time to dedicate to income generating activities. Such programs could engage the husbands of women in saving groups (ibimina), or of women in micro, small, or medium enterprises (MSMEs) in different sectors. If the women's economic empowerment program targets young women or girls, their fathers, brothers, and uncles could also be engaged, to challenge the gendered stereotypes that hold women and girls back from economic development, as well as to build family support around more structural issues that women face, like the lack of collateral (ingwate).

A gender transformative component engaging men and boys should also be integrated into all programs promoting girls' and young women's employment and transition to work. In addition to career guidance, skill-based and leadership training, boys and girls, as well as their parents, should be engaged in open conversations to challenge the different

gender norms and social expectations placed on girls and young women vs boys and young men at the time of completing secondary education.

As there is a strong linkage between the effects of climate change, increased GBV in families, and increased burden of unpaid care work on women, interventions targeting individuals and families affected by climate change and natural disasters are also encouraged to engage men to prevent and mitigate such risks.

Interventions engaging men and boys in gender transformative conversations should also include caring for the environment as one of the components of a more positive definition of masculinity. In this way, men and boys can also be more easily engaged in positive behaviours for environmental protection and climate change-related risk mitigation.

Transformational governance:

Designing and testing gender transformative programs that engage the partners of women's leaders in Rwanda are encouraged to create positive support at the family level around their role within the communities. Sessions should ideally target couples, and build men's understanding about their partners' role at the community level, as well as of their own role to support them. Discussing unpaid care work and involving men in sharing related tasks is also important to reduce its burden on women, and grant women enough time to exercise their duty in the community.

Efforts should also be made to engage the partners of women leaders at a high level. Although work engaging men in Rwanda has been mostly done in rural areas, working with rural people and couples, the Strategy encourages innovative initiatives to engage the male partners of high-level women leaders both in the private and the public sectors. Such initiatives could be thought of as short online discussions or virtual training, or a one-day workshop. They could be promoted alongside capacity-building initiatives targeting women leaders.

Train men in positions of power on how to encourage and support women's leadership within organizations/institutions. Such training should address gender unconscious bias at the workplace and in hiring processes, as well as raise awareness about possible organizational measures to support women rise to leadership positions (flexible working arrangements, competency-based performance appraisal…)

Community-level strategies

Community-based approaches engaging men and boys aim at changing community gender norms around gender and violence. The importance of working with communities lies in the fact that, while most Men Engage interventions try to modify gender attitudes and behaviors at the individual level, there is also a need to prepare the community to receive the transformed roles and power dynamics. This is done to create a conducive environment, in order to ensure that the change can be sustained and to minimize the risk of backlash/negative impact towards the transformed individuals or households (do no harm).

In this section, some of the best practices on how to engage men and boys at the community level will be presented. The majority of them apply across the three thematic areas, while a few of them are specific to the social inclusion one.

Across all thematic areas:

Working with male leaders is very critical, as a way to create a conducive environment for individual behavior change. Leaders have a strong influence on community beliefs and practices and they normally have existing structures and platforms through which they can disseminate information and influence others. They can be a very effective intermediary in disseminating positive information within communities, and particularly to men, about SRHR, gender equality, and GBV prevention, but also about supporting women's involvement in paid work and women's leadership. To meaningfully work with them, it is important to first identify the most progressive ones among them, train them in a transformative way – in order to unpack their own gender beliefs – and also support them in preparing the content to engage the community members.

When working with faith leaders specifically, it is important to acknowledge that harmful interpretations of the religious documentation often allow gender inequality to continue, and are often even used to justify violence and women's exclusion from leadership and economic empowerment. Therefore, there is a need to promote a more progressive interpretation of religious books, supporting leaders to extrapolate the parts of the books that present a more equitable representation of women and their relationship with men.

On a technical level, faith organizations can organize workshops where participants engage in role-playing exercises to address gender discrimination. These activities help participants develop empathetic responses and solutions rooted in religious principles that champion gender equality. Together with this, Religious Teachings can create sermon series and study groups centered around gender equality, focusing on showcasing positive role models and religious teachings that advocate for and support gender equity, encouraging communities to embrace transformative practices.

The use of role models/champions at the community level is particularly effective in promoting a shared understanding of the benefits that gender equality (increased women's empowerment, GBV reduction, or male engagement in unpaid care work) can bring to the household. Couple testimonies, as well as male role models' speeches at selected community events, are powerful tools to extend gender-transformative conversations from the family to the wider community level.

Build the capacity of existing networks of community-based volunteers, including the Community Health Workers (CHWs), the Inshuti z'umuryango (IZU), as well as the National Women Council (NWC) and National Youth Council (NYC) representatives. Investing in gender transformative training of such networks is strongly recommended, so that they become able to engage men and boys within their routine work of home visits, as well as during the time dedicated to community sensitization across a wide range of topics touching all thematic areas (SRHR, MNCH, economic empowerment, participation in politics and so on).

Use existing community-based spaces to engage men and boys in gender-related discussions, and to disseminate gender-transformative messages to the whole community. Such spaces include umuganda, inteko z'abaturage and imigoroba y'imiryango. Messages in such spaces

can be given by trained community volunteers, by Community Activists, or by trained male leaders. Project-based Men Engage Clubs are also encouraged to use such spaces for their own meetings, and in order to involve other community members in relevant conversations around GBV prevention and men's and boys' role in unpaid care work and more broadly in supporting women's and girls' empowerment.

Organize gender transformative media campaigns targeting specifically men and boys around gender equality and violence prevention. It is important to tailor the campaign to the target audience (age brackets, urban vs rural, choice of testimonials), to make sure that both the right channel and the right tone are used. When engaging men and boys, it is also encouraged to send positive messages, to bring them on board, like telling them that consensual sex, unpaid care work, and shared decision-making at home are actions of good, fair, respectable, and respectful men, and emphasizing the benefits that they bring in their lives.

Identify, train, and collaborate with online and offline influencers to reach the youth with messages around gender equality, women's and girls' empowerment, climate justice, and GBV prevention. It is important to identify influencers who have a strong influence over the youth and who are active in the spaces where youth can be found. They can be online influencers – to target urban youth, sports stars or even artists, who are all well-known and popular. Involving them in media campaigns as testimonials can be a powerful way to spread messages on gender equality, and thus effectively positively engage young men and boys.

Social inclusion area:

Community-level engagement of men is of particular importance when it comes to programming related to ending GBV. Even though individuals commit violence, community attitudes shape how perpetrators are perceived, how violence is perceived (an expression of manhood or a violation of women's rights?) and how victims are treated and considered. One of the ways in which men can be engaged at the community level is through the Community Activism Model, which normally follows the implementation of the couple training curriculum to prevent GBV (See Box 2). Selected women and men from the group education sessions get additional training on activism, as well as some tools to engage communities (illustrations, booklets). Using existing

community fora, trained community activists (CAs) engage community members in gender transformative discussions around power and violence, as well as in raising their awareness about existing laws. CAs can also target men within masculine spaces, like bars or stadiums, and engage them in short discussions or debates on gender topics.

Another approach is the creation of Men Engage clubs, where community members, both women and men, can meet and discuss gender norms and GBV within their own communities. Men Engage clubs work best when they are started by individuals who have gone through a training program and who can facilitate gender transformative discussions. Members of the Men Engage clubs are often approached by women and men who live in conflict, to seek their guidance and advice. Couples reached by men's clubs and who have managed to solve their problems are often motivated to join the club too. Such couples often share their own testimonies within community gatherings, to give a positive message of change to the wider community.

In order to sustain change in the community, men and boys should also be engaged as active bystanders. This means that interventions should provide them with the necessary confidence and skills to speak up when they see acts of gender inequality or violence within their communities. By calling out and holding other men and boys perpetrating GBV, they will contribute to creating a more peaceful and equitable community, and they will show their own peers that violence is not tolerated or condoned.

An approach that is particularly effective for youth is the creation (or the reinforcement) of gender youth clubs in schools discussing GBV or SRHR, at the end of a school- based gender training. Individual boys and girls who have been trained can start up a club (or can enrich the discussions of an existing one), and use the space to continue gender-related discussions or debates and even engage more students. When working through school-based clubs, it is also important to make sure that teachers, school authorities, and possibly also parents are on-board, so that club members can meet regularly and freely discuss.

Community-based campaigns making use of drama, role plays, and music are also encouraged to disseminate gender-transformative messages to community members about gender equality or GBV prevention., and to depict positive representation of male behaviors. Such activities can be encouraged during relevant international days, such as International Women's Day or the 16 Days of Activism, to ensure positive awareness raising through entertainment.

Interventions promoting boys' and girls' SRHR should also target the wider community, in order to create a conducive environment towards young people's uptake of existing services, reducing the stigma at the community as well as the facility level. Communities should also be made aware of the power dynamics between boys and girls in their relationships during adolescence, and also encourage parents of adolescent boys to teach them about their positive role in the prevention of unwanted pregnancies and STIs.

Finally, Mass and public communication strategies also play a crucial role in advancing gender transformative approaches and addressing harmful gender norms affecting both Men and Boys and Women and Girls:

Implementing awareness campaigns in transport hubs with posters and digital ads featuring GBV prevention messages can effectively reach commuters. Interactive kiosks offering educational content, along with community ambassadors engaging in direct conversations, further enhance awareness. In markets, street theater performances and interactive booths can use entertainment and incentives to educate visitors on gender equality. Public screens can broadcast educational videos and feature daily messages or live Q&A sessions to keep the community informed. Exhibitions can provide immersive experiences through interactive installations and art showcases, complemented by workshops and panels. In schools, educational animations, interactive quizzes, and student projects can foster early awareness and engagement. Across all venues, storytelling campaigns, collaborations with influencers, and feedback mechanisms ensure that communication remains impactful, relevant, and continuously improving in promoting gender equality and preventing GBV.

6.1.3. Institutional and policy level strategies

For changes at the individual, household, and community levels to be effective, it is important to intervene at the level of the broader policy and

power dynamics but also the way changes at the individual level and at the community level can be received and sustained.

Across all thematic areas:
Stakeholders are encouraged to prioritize institutional capacity building of men and boys in decision-making positions to make sure that they are accountable for changing institutional structures of patriarchy and to address policy gaps that hinder meaningful participation of women in economic development and political leadership. In particular, it is recommended that they should be sensitized on the theme of unpaid care work and the impact it has on women and girls' lives, for them to be able to promote policies and initiatives that aim at recognizing, reducing, and redistributing unpaid care work, according to the model of the 3R (See Box 3).
The Strategy encourages different stakeholders to invest in capacity building through gender transformative approaches of technical government staff at all levels, starting with the offices which are responsible for the promotion of gender equality and gender mainstreaming in different sectors. Such capacity-building initiatives should first aim at engaging them as individuals, who need to first reflect on their own understanding of gender equality, social norms, and gender stereotypes. Building on their individual transformation, they should later increase their knowledge and skills to implement existing gender policies in a gender-transformative way by engaging men and boys.

Box 3: 3 R of unpaid Care Work.
This is a Strategy to address unpaid care work, which includes:
Recognition: making unpaid care work visible, by qualitatively and quantitatively documenting it, as a basis for monitoring strategies to address it.
Reduction: alleviating the burden of unpaid care work on women and girls by investing in social care and physical infrastructure, or labour-saving infrastructure and technologies.
Redistribution: sharing more equally the tasks associated with unpaid care work between women, men, boys, and girls at the household level, but also between government, the private sector and community as well.

The Strategy calls for initiatives to put in place and strengthen anti-sexual harassment policies and mechanisms at the institutional level in the public and the private sector. In particular, it is recommended that such initiatives should not only discuss reporting and sanctions but also integrate prevention measures. The creation of safer work and study settings is paramount to support women and girls' empowerment and career progression at the workplace, as well as women's and girls' education and women's and girls' participation in political leadership.

Male leaders and decision-makers should also be engaged as allies in critical advocacy initiatives aiming at promoting vulnerable women's empowerment security and human rights. For example, advocacy initiatives to extend maternity benefits or social protection for rural women, or women with disabilities.

Building the capacity of the communication offices of different government institutions is also encouraged, through the use of gender transformative approaches. Investing in training for government communication office staff is key, in order to promote the production of communication messages for online and offline campaigns across different thematic areas which does not reproduce unequal power dynamics and gender norms, but on the contrary challenges stereotypes and negative social norms.

Social inclusion thematic area:

Engaging men will become more ingrained and sustainable if there is an institutional culture that supports men taking leave and actively balancing work and home responsibilities. Workplaces should create a conducive environment that values the male role in parenting.

It is recommended that all institutions and organizations encourage the uptake of paternity leave by their male employees, possibly in combination with gender transformative conversation about their role as fathers. Providing paternity leave allows men to bond with their children at an early age and take on a larger role in family responsibilities, which can contribute to positive child development through more equitable parenting. Ideally, given the current understanding of the meaning of paternity leave within communities, public and private workplaces should emphasize paternity leave being an important moment for the fathers to bond with their children, be involved in caregiving, and support the mother, instead of just a time of celebration among male friends. Initiatives like short discussions on male

involvement in childcare and caregiving, as well as on the available health services for new-born babies are encouraged, during all staff meetings or on a one-to-one basis (for example in the week before the beginning of the leave).

Service-based interventions are highly efficient approaches, particularly in combination with individual approaches engaging men for behavior change. For example, building health care workers' capacity to engage with and serve men is encouraged, in combination with individual approaches engaging men in SRHR or MNCH. Once healthcare workers feel more confident and comfortable discussing sexual and reproductive health and family planning with men, they are better able to serve male clients in a stigma-free environment. If this is not done, the risk is that interventions might generate a new demand or new behaviours, which might not be accommodated at the health facility level.

Consider engaging men within key institutions for GBV response such as the police, health workers, and judiciary, since they have a role to play in providing safe, response services to survivors of VAWG. In this way, women are more likely to receive the support they need and not to be exposed to further violence or discrimination.

The strategy encourages initiatives to build the capacity of the staff in the education sector at all levels. Gender transformative training of the technical staff in charge of monitoring and reviewing national school curricula at all educational levels is key to ensuring that the relevant curricula contribute to positive gender norm change and address persistent barriers like the gendered nature of unpaid care work. Similarly, gender transformative training of teachers and school authorities is also a powerful tool to ensure that teachers can integrate gender equality within their teaching styles and practices. Such gender transformative training should aim at equipping teachers with a critical lens to be able to analyze the gendered nature of the learning environment and respond to it in a transformative way by engaging boys, alongside girls, in critical discussions on gender equality and unpaid care work.

Public and private investment strategies to reduce unpaid care work, including investing in social care infrastructure or in physical rural infrastructure are strongly encouraged as a positive way to reduce time spent on unpaid care work for both women and men. However, this should ideally be accompanied by transformative campaigns targeting women, girls, and men and boys with gender-specific messages to encourage the redistribution of unpaid care work from women to men and girls to boys at the household level. Initiatives to reduce unpaid care work through the provision of social care, could potentially even pass the opposite message that men have less obligation since such measures are in place to facilitate women. It is important that discussions and mechanisms adopted at the national level or at the workplace level to ease the burden of unpaid care work on women, should also intentionally engage men, to make them feel that such initiatives are also for them, as parents and as caregivers.

Economic empowerment and climate justice:

The Strategy encourages different stakeholders to prioritize institutional capacity building at all levels, to make sure that policy and decision-makers, as well as leaders within the private sectors, are accountable for changing institutional structures of patriarchy and addressing policy gaps that hinder meaningful participation of women and men in economic development. In particular, a strong focus should be put on addressing policy gaps that hamper the creation of a safe and enabling working environment for women to be able to balance productive and reproductive roles.

Service-based interventions are also encouraged in programs engaging men in women's economic empowerment or access to finance. Gender transformative training of financial service providers (FSPs) and mobile network operators (MNOs), is recommended, to enhance their capacity to tailor their products and their service delivery in a gender-responsive way.

Gender transformative training targeting the leadership and the management (often male) of the private sector is also an effective tool to ensure equality in employment benefits, including wages, annual leave, and social security benefits. This would result in a more conducive environment for women and girls. Leadership should be

encouraged to promote practices of remote working or flexible working arrangements. Such training should also aim at informing their business model, their products, and their marketing strategies, producing a ripple effect that can be visible within the market and communities at large.

Engage male leaders in advocating for the implementation of social security benefits in the informal sector through saving schemes as well as within communities (for example, by including maternity and paternity benefits within saving schemes like Ejo Heza).

(Transformational governance)

Engaging male political leaders as transformative agents of change is encouraged in order to create high-level support for women's rights and also for gender equality. This has the potential to both create a more conducive environment for women's leaders within political parties and political institutions, but also to enhance male leaders' support for grassroots initiatives or civil-society-based advocacies to promote women's and girls' rights. Men can support or co-sponsor women's proposed agendas to bring mainstream attention to such issues or they can support female politicians' efforts outside of the gender equality arena. They can contribute to cross-gender mentorship initiatives to support women building their legitimacy in the political space. Men can also support and champion family-friendly and gender-equitable policies and practices within institutions and act as role models in holding their male peers accountable for sexist and or discriminatory attitudes and behaviors.

In order to be able to engage male political leaders or male within high-level decision-making position, it is strategic to combine masculinity/gender transformative training within more general skill-based training that they are likely to attend in the framework of their individual capacity development. Therefore, the creation of integrated curricula is recommended to the private and public institutions proposing training to high level leaders.

The following section focuses on the implementation framework of the Strategy, detailing responsibilities and roles of the different actors involved, in supervising, implementing and monitoring the Strategy implementation at different levels.

7. Coordination framework

The Strategy's implementation will be based on existing institutional structures and coordination mechanisms in order to develop functional and sustainable approaches at the local and national levels.

7.1. Responsibility

MIGEPROF leads the process of coordinating the implementation of the Strategy. It is responsible for getting buy-in from national stakeholders and providing strategic guidance. MIGEPROF will also lead the detailed planning and delivery process, including budgeting and resource mobilization functions to ensure adherence to priorities set in the strategic framework and alignment with the orientation of the National Gender Policy. Operationalization at the technical level will happen through established frameworks in close consultation with the Permanent Secretaries Forum and the sector working groups, which bring together sector actors, such as the Private Sector Federation and development partners, that will be responsible for key implementation actions in the strategy. The strategy's results measurement framework must be aligned with broader sector targets under the joint sector reviews.

MIGEPROF will continue to provide the requisite signals that the Strategy Engaging Men and Boys is a priority. It will also advocate for the implementation of the strategy in its policy dialogue with various stakeholders in the context of implementing programs under the development strategies. MIGEPROF will engage all government ministries and local government entities to implement the strategy through the programs and sub-programs as an aspect of gender mainstreaming for equality and women's empowerment. MIGEPROF will engage development partners and civil society activists involved in women's and girls' rights on the Strategy and its activities through the partners' usual development support programs at all levels of the community (local and national).

MIGEPROF's Gender Promotion and Women Empowerment Directorate will be responsible for monitoring, evaluating, and reporting progress on Men Engage strategy implementation.

7.2. Coordination mechanisms

The smooth implementation of the Strategy requires a robust coordination mechanism. Coordination will generally take place at various levels, including at the ministerial level with an established steering committee and a technical committee.

7.2.1.Steering committee

The Strategy coordination will be guided by the decisions of a national steering committee to be set up by MIGEPROF. The steering committee will be chaired by the Minister of Gender and Family Promotion and co-chaired by the Minister of Local Government, and it will meet quarterly to provide guidance and orientation on the strategy implementation's key priorities in order to address major challenges that may hinder effective implementation. This committee will also be responsible for mobilizing the resources required to implement the strategy. Other members of the committee will include the Permanent Secretaries of the MoH, MINAGRI,

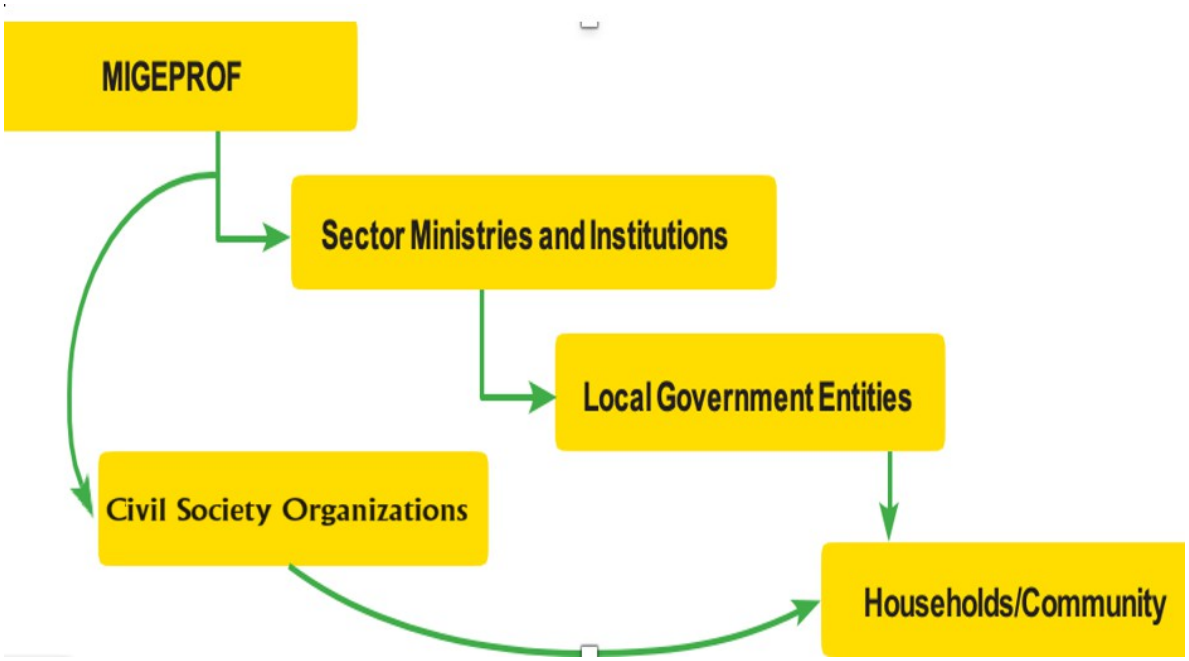
MINEDUC, and MINICOM and the Directors General of the National Child Development Agency, Rwanda Biomedical Centre, and Local Administrative Entities Development Agency (LODA). MIGEPROF may decide to have other stakeholders on the committee.

7.2.2. Technical committee (national level)

The working technical committee will bring together technical persons representing MIGEPROF, MINICOM, MINEDUC, MoH, the Ministry of Agriculture and Agricultural Resources, the National Child Development Agency, the Rwanda Biomedical Centre, LODA and the Private Sector Federation. They will meet regularly to assess progress on the Strategy implementation and address any technical challenges encountered during implementation.

7.2.3. Technical committee (district level)

At each district level, a working technical committee will be created, chaired by the Director of Good governance at the district level and co-chaired by the Gender Officer. Other members can include CSOs working in the district on GBV prevention and gender equality and family promotion, and



security organs like RIB, Police or army, selected representatives of opinion and religious leaders and one representative of all ESs of the sectors.

7.3. Accountability

Government institutions, districts, private entities, and CSOs will be accountable for ensuring the effective implementation of the Strategy in programs. In this respect, each institution and district will create a plan of action that identifies indicators, monitoring mechanisms, targets, time frames, and resources required to effectively implement the strategy.

7.4. Enhancement of the Men Engage Strategy

The strategy's successful implementation in diverse programs and the capacity to establish common ground on gender equality and women's empowerment issues with diverse partners require that government officials, development partners, CSOs, and communities at all levels are well informed and motivated to support its implementation. Therefore, capacity-building programs will be designed to cater to the different needs and levels of government officials in order to enhance their involvement. Such initiatives should not only increase the level of awareness of the Strategy, provide Sector-specific competence, and enable these officials to play an effective role in implementation, but they should also include skills in gender transformative approaches (GTA). MIGEPROF will develop tested models on GTA and facilitation skills for staff training, in collaboration with partners.

7.5 Monitoring

Monitoring the National Strategy's implementation through diverse programs will happen solely under the mandate of GMO. This will include ensuring that monitoring reports are produced and disseminated by the implementing agencies and ministries.

7.6 Implementation arrangements

The Table below offers a snapshot of the different roles and responsibilities of different actors involved in the policy implementation.

9ll	Roles and Responsibilities
MIGEPROF	➤➤ Has a responsibility for policy and strategic guidance on strategy implementation, resource mobilization, and prioritization of sectoral actions ➤➤ Organize and coordinate other stakeholders in the sectors ➤➤ Provide oversight on the implementation, coordination, and monitoring of strategy implementation
MoH, MINEDUC, MINALOC, MINICOM, Ministry of Agriculture and Animal Resources	➤➤ Support MIGEPROF in policy and strategic guidance on strategy implementation to ensure programs are inclusive of the strategy's objectives and resource mobilization, as well as prioritization of sectoral actions ➤➤ Coordinate institutions under the respective ministry for strategy implementation ➤➤ Coordinate districts in strategy implementation
Districts, LODA, Rwanda Biomedical Centre, National Child Development Agency	➤➤ Implement the strategy through programs and sub-programs ➤➤ Provide quarterly and/or annual reports on strategy implementation
MINECOFIN	➤➤ Ensure equitable resource mobilization and alignment with the NST1 strategy objectives
CSOs, academia, media (among other key stakeholders)	➤➤ Implement the strategy through advocacy ➤➤ Undertake evaluation of the Strategy approaches to inform policy ➤➤ Engage stakeholders at each institutional level in strategy implementation

7.7 Resource implication

The operationalization of the Strategy will not necessarily mean providing for separate budget allocations or seeking additional resources to engage men and boys. It will entail an analysis of how the government's core resources,and in particular, annual budget programs and activities, can be planned and allocated to ensure a good balance of gender-responsive and gender-transformative initiatives. Thus, gender transformative activities related to engaging men and boys will constitute part of the regular budget. Through its partners, MIGEPROF will solicit financial support to enhance the strategy's implementation at the institutional, local government, and community levels.

7.8 Institutional strengthening

The Men Engage strategy will be implemented in alignment with the National Gender Policy. At the MIGEPROF level, the Gender Promotion and Women Empowerment Directorate will lead implementation with the currently available staff. However, MIGEPROF requires a minimum of two staff members to strengthen the directorate and make the strategy's implementation tenable. The expertise that will be necessary in the first year of strategy implementation includes (i) the specialist in Engaging Men and (ii) the officer in charge of the Strategy implementation

8.Risk analysis and mitigation measures

The following table presents a risk analysis per thematic area, highlighting the risks, its intensity and the mitigation measures proposed.

Area	Strategic Outcomes	Description of Latent Risk	Intensity	Mitigation Measures
Social inclusion	An increased percentage of women and girls enjoy a life free from violence due to transformed masculinities	Slow engagement of the strategy in Programs Slow policy adoption Emphasis kept exclusively on GBV Response	Low	Create an enabling environment for strategy adoption Establish long-term sector adoption of the strategy and increase awareness and incentives Ensure alignment with existing imihigo Sensitize institutions about the importance of GBV prevention Integrate GBV prevention within programs on women's economic empowerment
	Women's and girls' level of education increases across all course options	Slow engagement of the strategy in Programs Slow policy adoption De-prioritization of the Strategy in the education sector	Medium	Create an enabling environment for strategy adoption Establish long-term sector adoption of the strategy and increase awareness and incentives Ensure alignment with existing imihigo Sensitize institutions in the education sector about the importance of EMB and how to do it Integrate EMB within existing programs and initiatives

	Men and boys are increasingly involved in unpaid care work related tasks	Low/limited capacity to effectively align the strategy to unpaid care work programs Adaptation risks emanating from cultural values	Medium	Ensure alignment with existing Strategic Plans and Programs Increase capacity building of implementing institutions in terms of integration on unpaid care work Engage community organisations and CSOs. Leverage existing evidence related to the positive impacts across different outcomes of men's and boys' increased engagement in unpaid care work for creating support from institutions, partners and donors
Economic empowerment and climate justice	Increased and sustained livelihoods for women and girls Improved women and girls' access to and utilisation of formal and informal financial services	Slow pace of establishing strategy linkage to private sector programs Deprioritization of the Strategy in the economic empowerment and financial sector Adaptation risks emanating from cultural values Implementation skills and quantity of personnel required at institutional levels and within the private sector	Medium	Engage the private sector in implementing the strategy Engage community organisations and CSOs Ensure alignment with existing imihigo Strengthen resource mobilisation for women and girls' business ventures Work to ensure the government engages stakeholders and strengthens public-private partnerships Build capacity of the personnel of financial institutions and their awareness about social norms

Transformative governance	Women and girls' representation in decision-making positions increases across all levels and sectors Increased women's voice and participation in decision-making	Deprioritization of the Strategy for an exclusive focus on women's leadership skills; Difficulty in changing cultural beliefs and practices around gender and leadership.	Medium	Build awareness on the role of social norm transformation in women's political participation. Leverage synergies with existing programs on women's and girls' leadership, rather than standalone interventions. Align targets with imihigo at the national/district levels

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Annex 1.Strategy Action Plan and Implementation Indicators Matrix

Cross-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Central and local government technical staff are trained on EMB approaches	Availability of GTA/ EMB approach training manual (monitoring and evaluation plan)	To be determined (TBD)	100% of training manuals developed					**1.** Develop a EMB approach training manual. **2.** Conduct training sessions on the EMB approach for central and local government technical staff.	MIGEPROF (lead), ministries, districts, development partners, CSOs	25,000,000
	Proportion of technical staff trained (disaggregated by gender)	TBD	40% of technical staff trained	20% of technical staff trained (total trained since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of technical staff trained (total trained since strategy initiation: 80%)	10% of technical staff trained (total trained since strategy initiation: 90%)	10% of technical staff trained (total trained since strategy initiation: 100%)			100,000,000
	Proportion of administrative sectors reached by the EMB approach	TBD	20% of sectors reached	20% of sectors reached (total sector reached since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of sectors reached (total sector reached since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of sectors reached (total sector reached since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of sectors reached (total sector reached since strategy initiation: 100%)	**1.** Conduct training sessions on the EMB approach with community health workers.	MIGEPROF (lead), MINALOC, MoH, districts, CSOs	70,000,000
Priority Thematic Area 1: Social inclusion										
Strategic Objective 1: To enhance equitable social norms through promoting positive masculinities in education, health, and GBV prevention										
Strategic Outcome 1.1: An increased percentage of women and girls enjoy a life free from violence due to engaging men and boys on GBV prevention Outcome Indicator: 1: Prevalence of GBV among women, girls, men and boys in all its forms 2: Attitudes towards gender norms in intimate relationships (GEM Scale) 3: Number of couples formalizing their union										

Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Women and men undergo gender transformative couple training on GBV prevention	Number of couples trained on gender equality in intimate relationships	TBD	100 of couples trained	100 couples trained (total since strategy initiation: 200)	100 couples trained (total since strategy initiation: 300)	100 couples trained (total since strategy initiation: 400)	100 of couples trained (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Adapt existing tested couple curricula/approaches for GBV prevention (ex. Indashyikirwa) 2. Conduct in-depth gender transformative couple training in selected districts of the country 3. Conduct GTA mobilization of community members, specifically targeting men about the importance of formal unions	MIGEPROF (lead), MINALOC, districts, CSOs	120,000,000
IZUs and UWIs' knowledge about GTA and EMB increased	Proportion of IZUs and UWIs trained (disaggregated by category, gender and age range)	TBD	10% of IZUs and UWIs	20% IZUs and UWIs (total trained since strategy initiation: 30%)	30% IZUs and UWIs (total trained since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% IZUs and UWIs (total trained since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% IZUs and UWIs (total trained since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Conduct training sessions on EMB approaches with CHWs, UWIs and IZUs	MIGEPROF (lead), MINALOC, districts, CSOs	150,000,000
Existing spaces engaging parents of youth host discussions about positive masculinity	Proportion of relevant community-based fora (imigoroba w'imiryango) where discussions about positive masculinity take place	TBD	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since	1. Equip them with simplified materials 2. Follow up and monitoring visits	MIGEPROF (lead), MINALOC, CSOs	100,000,000

prevention	vs in communities)		'	, (total trained since strategy initiation: 100)	, (total trained since strategy initiation: 150)	, (total trained since strategy initiation: 200)	, (total trained since strategy initiation: 250)	perpetrators of violence		

Cross-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Boys and girls who have grown in violent homes receive psycho-social support, including with messages about PM and GBV prevention	Number of boys and girls who received psycho-social support, integrated with messages on PM (disaggregated by sex and age)	TBD	50 youth reached with psychos-social support	50 youth reached with psychos-social support (total trained since strategy initiation: 100)	50 youth reached with psychos-social support (total trained since strategy initiation: 100)	50 youth reached with psychos-social support (total trained since strategy initiation: 100)	50 youth reached with psychos-social support (total trained since strategy initiation: 100)	1.Psycho-social support packages for youth victims of GBV is updated with PM content 2. Psycho-social sessions are carried out with youth living in families with GBV	MIGEPROF, MoH, CSOs	70,000,000
Men and boys within communities are reached with messages around PM and GBV prevention	Number of men and boys reached with messages around positive masculinities and GBV prevention (on-line and offline)	TBD	10% of men/ boys with improved positive attitudes	20% of men/ boys with improved positive attitudes (total since strategy initiation: 30%)	20% of men/ boys with improved positive attitudes (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	30% of men/ boys with improved positive attitudes (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of men/ boys with improved positive attitudes (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Online and offline campaigns on positive masculinity are organized; 2. Home visits by community volunteers target men with messages around GBV and positive masculinity; 3. Men and boys undergo GTA training	MIGEPROF (lead), MINALOC, MINACO,MoH, districts, CSOs	20,000,000
Strategic Outcome 1.2: Women's and girls' level of education increases across all course options thanks to programs/initiatives around positive masculinity Outcome Indicator 1: Number of women and girls completing tertiary education 2: Number of women and girls joining STEM at tertiary level 3: Attitudes towards women's and girls' education										
Young people in secondary schools undergo training on PM	Number of young people trained on positive masculinities and femininities (disaggregated by gender)	TBD	1000 trained students in schools	2000 trained students in schools (total since strategy initiation: 3000)	2000 trained students in schools (total since strategy initiation: 5000)	3000 trained students in schools (total since strategy initiation: 8000)	2000 trained students in schools (total since strategy initiation: 10000)	1.Develop training manuals on positive masculinities and femininities targeting secondary school students; 2. Conduct gender transformative dialogues in primary, secondary, and higher education institutions.	MIGEPROF (lead), MINEDUC, CSOs	120,000,000

Teachers are engaged on GTA and PM	Proportion of teachers engaged on PM (disaggregated by gender and age range)	TBD	20% of teachers trained	20% of teachers trained (total trained since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of teachers trained (total trained since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of teachers trained (total trained since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of teachers trained (total trained since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Conduct GTA training with teachers		20,000,000

Cross-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Existing spaces engaging parents of youth host discussions about positive masculinity	Proportion of relevant community-based fora (imigoroba w'imiryango) where discussions about positive masculinity take place	TBD	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Train UWIs and IZUs on PM 2. Equip them with simplified materials	MIGEPROF (lead), MINALOC, CSOs	100,000,000
Gender Youth Clubs are created in school	Number of gender youth clubs (Y4C) clubs established at schools	TBD	50 Y4C clubs established	50 Y4C clubs established (total clubs established since strategy initiation: 100)	50 Y4C clubs established (total clubs established since strategy initiation: 150)	50 Y4C clubs established (total clubs established since strategy initiation: 200)	50 Y4C clubs established (total clubs established since strategy initiation: 250)	Support the set up or the strengthening of in-school youth clubs focusing on gender and PM	MIGEPROF (lead), MINEDUC, CSOs	50,000,000
GTA training manuals for youth are developed	Availability of module/ teaching manual on positive masculinities and femininities practices	TBD	100% of a full training module/ manual developed		100% of a full training module/ manual revised			1. Adapt/develop existing Y4C materials	MIGEPROF (lead), MINEDUC, CSOs	
PM and GTA kits are developed for Y4C in-school clubs	Availability of PM and GTA kits for Y4C clubs	TBD	20% of the Y4C clubs are equipped with kits	20% of the Y4C clubs are equipped with kits (total clubs equipped since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of the Y4C clubs are equipped with kits (total clubs equipped since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of the Y4C clubs are equipped with kits (total clubs equipped since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of the Y4C clubs are equipped with kits (total clubs equipped since strategy initiation: 100%)	2. Kits distribution	MIGEPROF (lead), MINEDUC, CSOs	10,000,000
Strategic Outcome 1.3: Increased positive SRHR health-seeking behaviours of women, girls, men and boys Outcome Indicator 1: Number of youth aged 15-24 accessing SRHR services and products (contraceptives, HIV testing) 2: Number of girls 15-19 who are pregnant with their first child or who have given birth 3: Male accompaniment of women to ANC related services (all 4 visits)										

Cross-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Knowledge on the EMB and GTA approach increases in health system	Proportion of administrative sectors reached by the EMB approach	TBD	20% of sectors reached	20% of sectors reached (total sector reached since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of sectors reached (total sector reached since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of sectors reached (total sector reached since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of sectors reached (total sector reached since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Conduct training sessions on the EMB approach with community health workers.	MIGEPROF (lead), MINALOC, MoH, districts, CSOs	70,000,000
	Proportion of community health workers trained (disaggregated by gender and age range)	TBD	10% of community health workers trained	20% of community health workers trained (total CHWs trained since strategy initiation: 30%)	30% of community health workers trained (total CHWs trained since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of community health workers trained (total CHWs trained since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of community health workers trained (total CHWs trained since strategy initiation: 100%)			
Fathers with children below 5 are reached with GTA training on MNCH and positive parenting	Proportion of men reached by messages around positive parenting and male involvement in childcare	TBD	10% of men reached	20% of men reached (total since strategy initiation: 30%)	20% of men reached (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	30% of men reached (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of men reached (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Adapt existing couple curricula and conduct gender transformative training on MNCH, SRHR and positive parenting in selected districts of the country 2. Scale up couples' curricula aiming at promoting positive parenting and men engagement in caregiving (e.g., Bandebereho model).	MIGEPROF (lead), MOH, CSOs	200,000,000
Messages about positive masculinity in SRHR reach young people in their communities	Proportion of young people who are reached by messages on positive masculinities and femininities and SRHR (disaggregated by gender)	TBD	10% of young people out of school with improved knowledge	20% of young people out of school with improved knowledge (total since strategy initiation: 30%)	20% of young people out of school with improved knowledge (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	30% of young people out of school with improved knowledge (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of young people out of school with improved knowledge (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Adapt training manuals on positive masculinities for youth and conduct dialogues in youth spaces at community level 2. Online and offline campaigns	MIGEPROF (lead), MoH, CSOs	

Cross-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
	Number of youth leaders equipped with GTA and SRHR training as ToT (NYC, Youth Volunteers) in selected geographical areas	TBD	10% of youth leaders equipped	20% of youth leaders equipped (total since strategy initiation: 30%)	20% of youth leaders equipped (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	30% of youth leaders equipped (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of youth leaders equipped (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. ToT with youth leaders	MIGEPROF, MINIYOUTH, NYC, CSOs	
Health service providers are trained on GTA and EMB	Proportion of health service providers with increased knowledge on EMB	TBD	10% of health service providers trained	20% of health service providers trained (total HSPs trained since strategy initiation: 30%)	30% of health service providers trained (total HSPs trained since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of health service providers trained (total HSPs trained since strategy initiation:: 80%)	20% of health service providers trained (total HSPs trained since strategy initiation: 100%)	Conduct training sessions on the EMB approach with health service providers	MIGEPROF (lead), MOH, RBC, CSOs	
Strategic Outcome 1.4: Men and boys are increasingly involved in unpaid care work related tasks Outcome Indicator 1: Average hours per week spent on unpaid care work (both men and women) Outcome indicator 2: Attitudes towards male involvement in unpaid care work										
Community members are reached with GTA messages about men's and boys' involvement in caregiving in selected geographic areas	Proportion of people reached via online and offline campaigns on male involvement in caregiving in selected geographic areas	TBD	10% of community members reached via campaigns on positive masculinities	20% of community members reached via campaigns on positive masculinities (total community members reached since strategy initiation: 30%)	30% of community members reached via campaigns on positive masculinities (total community members reached since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of community members reached via campaigns on positive masculinities (total community members reached since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of community members reached via campaigns on positive masculinities (total community members reached since strategy initiation: 100%)	Conduct online and offline campaigns on positive masculinities and men's involvement in caregiving	MIGEPROF (lead), MINICOM, RBA, CSOs	

-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Women and men, boys and girls undergo GTA training on PM, and UCW redistribution	Number of trained individuals are trained on male involvement in UCW	TBD	10% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW	20% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW (total since strategy initiation: 30%)	20% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	30% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Adapt existing curricula on EMB in caregiving; 2. conduct GTA training in selected districts of the country (couples or youth)	MIGEPROF (lead), MOH, CSOs	60,000,000
Existing spaces engaging women and men host discussions about PM and UCW	Proportion of relevant community based fora (imigoroba w'imiryango) where discussions about PM and UCW take place	TBD	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of imigoroba w'imiryango host discussions about positive masculinities (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Train UWIs and other local structures on EMB and caregiving; 2. Create content for UWIs (booklet) to support them facilitate dialogues;	MIGEPROF, CSOs	120,000,000
Priority Thematic Area 2: Economic empowerment										
Strategic objective 2: To improve the economic welfare of women and girls at the individual and household levels through the promotion of positive masculinities										
Strategic outcome 2.1: Increased and sustained livelihoods for women and girls Outcome indicator 1: Number of women/girls who establish and expand sustainable businesses 2: Number of women/girls accessing decent jobs 3: Attitudes towards women and girls in paid work										
Men are trained on how to become allies in women's and girls' economic empowerment	Proportion of households reached by GTA couple training in economic empowerment/saving/ entrepreneurship in selected geographical areas	TBD	20% of households	20% of households (total since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of households (total since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of households (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of households (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	- Adapt/Update content for couple curriculum; - Rolling out couple training on engaging men as allies in women's economic empowerment (JoT)	MIGEPROF (lead), MINICOM, MINALOC, districts	100,000,000

Cross-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Leaders are engaged about women's economic empowerment	Proportion of leaders engaged around women's economic empowerment in selected geographical areas	TBD	20% of leaders engaged	20% of leaders engaged (total since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of leaders engaged (total since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of leaders engaged (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of leaders engaged (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	- Engagement sessions with leaders;	MIGEPROF (lead), MINICOM, MINALOC, districts	25,000,000
Community members are reached by positive messages around the role of men and boys in women's economic empowerment	Proportion of Community members are reached by positive messages	TBD	20% of community members reached	20% of community members reached (total since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of community members reached (total since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of community members reached (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of community members reached (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	- Targeted campaigns (on-line and off-line)	MINICOM, MINALOC, districts	20,000,000
Women and men, boys and girls undergo GTA training on PM, and UCW redistribution (same output as above)	Number of trained individuals are trained on male involvement in UCW	TBD	10% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW	20% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW (total since strategy initiation: 30%)	20% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	30% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of individuals are trained male involvement in UCW (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Adapt existing curricula on EMB in caregiving; 2. conduct GTA training in selected districts of the country (couples or youth)	MIGEPROF (lead), MOH, CSOs	- Covered above
Strategic Outcome 2.2: Improved women and girls' access to and utilisation of formal financial services due to EMB in women's and girls' economic empowerment Outcome Indicator 1: Number of women and girls accessing formal financial services Outcome indicator 2: Number of women and girls owning a saving account Outcome indicator 3: Attitudes towards women and girls' financial autonomy										

Cross-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Men and boys are reached by positive messages about women's and girls' financial autonomy	Percentage of men and boys reached by positive messages in targeted geographical areas	TBD	20% of men and boys reached	20% of men and boys reached (total since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of men and boys reached (total since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of men and boys reached (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of men and boys reached (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Engage men and boys through capacity building to reduce negative masculinities towards women and girls entrepreneurs and financial autonomy 2. Facilitate financial linkage for women and girls' ability to access markets.	MIGEPROF, MINALOC, LODA, districts	70,000,000
FSP are engaged and supported to promote women's/ girls' access to finances	Percentage of FSP engaged in selected geographical areas	TBD	20% of FSP engaged	30% of men and boys engaged (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	30% of FSP engaged (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	10% of FSP engaged (total since strategy initiation: 90%)	10% of FSP engaged (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	1. Engage FSPs in training about social norms and women's access to finance 2. Mobilise financial service providers to develop financial products/services tailored to women and girls' businesses.		50,000,000
Priority Thematic Area 3: Transformative governance										
Strategic Objective 3: To enhance women's meaningful political participation and decision-making										
Strategic Outcome 3.1: Women and girls' representation in decision-making positions increases across all levels and sectors Outcome Indicator 1: Number of women and girls in government leadership positions at all levels Outcome indicator 2: Number of women and girls in top management position within the private sector										

Cross-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Men and boys in communities are reached by messages about positive masculinity and supporting women's leadership	Percentage of men and boys in communities reached by messages around GTA and women's leadership (disaggregated per administrative level and sector)	TBD	10% of men and boys are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	10% of men and boys are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 60%)	10% of men and boys are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 70%)	5% of men and boys are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 75%)	5% of men and boys are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	1. Mobilise and build women and girls' capacity to leverage the opportunities offered by the existing strong political will in order for them to participate in leadership and governance, including in managerial positions and especially in local government, the private sector, and media. 2. Extensively engage men and boys and facilitate women and girls' participation in political spaces through mobilisation, capacity building, and dialogues at the community level on norms and beliefs around women and girls and political participation. 3. Engage women leaders' husbands in GTA training/ dialogues on supporting women's leadership	MIGEPROF, MINALOC, National Consultative Forum of Political Organizations, districts	120,000,000
Men decision makers are engaged around supporting women's leadership	Percentage of men politicians/decision makers reached by messages around GTA and women's leadership (disaggregated per administrative level and sector)	TBD	10% of men decision makers are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	10% of men decision makers are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 60%)	10% of men decision makers are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 70%)	5% of men decision makers are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 75%)	5% of men decision makers are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	1. Training of male decision makers about supporting women's leadership 2. Strengthen the capacity of women role models32. Strengthen existing mentorship and entrepreneurship programmes for girls and women	MIGEPROF, MINALOC, National Consultative Forum of Political Organizations, districts	50,000,000

Cross-cutting outputs contributing to the three areas										
Outputs	Performance Indicators	Baseline	Targets					Interventions to Deliver the Output	Responsible Institutions	Estimated Budget
			2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	2026-2027	2027-2028			
Private sector adopts measures to favor women's and girls' career progression	Number of private sector organizations which adopts policies and mechanisms to support women's and girls' progression (flexible working arrangements, longer maternity leave/ breastfeeding hours…)	TBD	10% of private sector organizations which adopt favourable measures	10% of private sector organizations which adopt favourable measures (total since strategy initiation: 20%)	10% of private sector organizations which adopt favourable measures (total since strategy initiation: 30%)	10% of private sector organizations which adopt favourable measures (total since strategy initiation: 40%)	10% of private sector organizations which adopt favourable measures (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	1. Awareness raising with PSF and companies' representatives;	MINICOM, RDB, PSF	40,000,000
Strategic Outcome 3.2: Increased women's voice and participation in decision-making Outcome Indictor 1: Percentage of women and girls who report they are able to influence decisions Outcome indicator 2: Attitudes and supportive behaviours towards women and girls in leadership Outcome indicator 3: Public institutions and private sector have in place policies and mechanisms to combat sexual harassment at the workplace										
Men decision makers are engaged around supporting women's leadership	Percentage of men politicians/decision makers reached by messages around GTA and women's leadership (disaggregated per administrative level and sector)	TBD	10% of women leaders' husbands are engaged	10% of women leaders' husbands are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 20%)	10% of women leaders' husbands are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 30%)	10% of women leaders' husbands are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 40%)	10% of women leaders' husbands are engaged (total since strategy initiation: 50%)	1. Training of male decision makers about supporting women's leadership 2. Strengthen the capacity of women role models 3. Strengthen existing mentorship and entrepreneurship programmes for girls and women	MIGEPROF, MINALOC, National Consultative Forum of Political Organizations, districts	50,000,000
Public institutions put in place mechanisms/ policies to prevent/ respond to SH	Number of institutions with an organizational policy on SH prevention	TBD	20% of institutions with a SH policy	20% of institutions with a SH policy (total since strategy initiation: 40%)	20% of institutions with a SH policy (total since strategy initiation: 60%)	20% of institutions with a SH policy (total since strategy initiation: 80%)	20% of institutions with a SH policy (total since strategy initiation: 100%)	Policy dialogues with relevant stakeholders	MIGEPROF, GMO, CSOs	20,000,000

Annex 2. Glossary of Gender Concepts

BENEFITS: Not simply income, material goods, or food for consumption or sale, but also status, power, respect, and recognition.

DEVELOPMENT: A process by which the members of a society increase their personal and institutional capacities to mobilise and manage resources in order to produce sustainable and equitably distributed improvements in their quality of life.

EMPOWERMENT: Achieving control over one's life through expanded choices. Empowerment encompasses self-sufficiency and self-confidence and is inherently linked to knowledge and voice. Empowerment is a function of individual initiative, which is facilitated by institutional change.

GENDER: The social meanings given to being either female or male in a given society. It may also be defined as the economic, social, political, and cultural attributes and opportunities associated with being male or female. These meanings and definitions vary from one society to another and are time-bound and changeable.

GENDER ANALYSIS: The systematic assessment of policy and practice related to women and policy and practice related to men and of the social and economic relationships between the two. Applying a gender perspective to the development issues being addressed requires analysing the gender division of labour, identifying the needs and priorities of women and men, identifying existing opportunities and constraints to the achievement of development objectives, and choosing an intervention strategy to address these.

GENDER BUDGET: A budgeting method that takes into account how a government or an organisation's budget affects men and women, boys and girls; it also looks at how the budget affects different groups of women and men, boys, and girls. A gender budget does not mean creating a separate budget or looking for additional resources for women and girls.

GENDER CONCERNS/ISSUES: Arise where an instance of gender inequality is recognised as unjust. For example, women having a lower literacy rate than men is a gender concern that a project requiring literacy skills would need to take into account. Other examples of gender-specific issues are female genital mutilation, violence against women, and discrimination against men in family planning services, among others.

GENDER-/SEX-DISAGGREGATED DATA: Collecting information and analysing results on the basis of gender/sex (e.g., data on the status and socioeconomic roles of different groups of men and women or data based on the biological attributes of women and men).

GENDER DISCRIMINATION: Providing differential treatment to individuals on the grounds of their gender. This involves systemic and structural discrimination against women in the distribution of income, access to resources, and participation in decision- making. Two types of gender discrimination may be cited: First, there is systemic discrimination, which is the entrenchment of social, cultural, and physical norms in an organization's processes and practices. It exists when an institution engages in practices that have a negative or differential impact on one gender. Second, structural discrimination exists where public or social institutions practice a societal system of gender discrimination. It becomes more entrenched if it is maintained by administrative rules and laws rather than only by custom and tradition.

GENDER DIVISION OF LABOUR: An overall societal pattern in which women are allotted one set of gender roles and men are allotted another. This division is not based on skill but on gender. An unequal gender division of labour refers to a situation in which not only does one gender category carry most of the burden of the labour in question but also there is an unequal division of rewards based on gender.

GENDER EQUALITY: Requires equal enjoyment by women and men of socially valued goods, opportunities, resources, and rewards. Achieving gender equality requires changes in the institutional practices and social relations through which disparities are reinforced and sustained.

GENDER EQUITY: A just distribution of benefits and rewards between men and women.

GENDER MAINSTREAMING: A process of identifying, taking full account of, and integrating the needs and interests of women and men into all policies, strategies, programs, and administrative and financial activities. It involves recognizing and examining the cooperative and conflictual relations that exist between women and men. It uses gender analysis as a tool to enhance and enable development practitioners to identify the opportunities and constraints that each gender faces and to determine whether the policies and programs that they implement provide the same opportunities for women and men. Gender mainstreaming also seeks to involve women, to the greatest possible extent, in the development decision-making process.

GENDER NEGATIVE: Solutions that reinforce gender inequalities through the use of gender norms, roles, and stereotypes for the program to achieve its objectives

GENDER NEUTRAL: Solutions that maintain a status quo and fail to recognize or address gender norms, roles, and stereotypes, and thus, support gender inequality

GENDER PERSPECTIVE: The view of problems, constraints, needs, and interests and also their relative significance from the standpoint of either women or men.

GENDER PLANNING: The formulation of specific strategies that aim to provide equal opportunities and benefits for both women and men.

GENDER ROLES: A social system of role classification, as opposed to a biological one. For example, if child-rearing is classified as a female role, it is a female gender role, not a female sex role; child-rearing can be done equally well by men and women. Gender roles lie in contrast to sex roles, which cannot be interchanged between the sexes.

GENDER SENSITIVE: Solutions that carefully consider gender issues and work within existing gender norms to address the exclusion of women; sometimes referred to as 'gender- smart' design

GENDER ROLE STEREOTYPING: The constant portrayal (in the media, the press, or education) of women and men occupying certain roles according to the socially constructed gender division of labour and expectations of behavior.

GENDER TRAINING: The provision of formal learning experiences and skills that recognize and address gender issues in the programming process to increase gender analysis and awareness skills.

GENDER TRANSFORMATIVE: Solutions that directly aim to transform power dynamics and structures that maintain gender inequalities; these go beyond the symptoms of gender inequality to address the norms, attitudes, behaviors, and social systems that underlie them

NEGATIVE/POSITIVE MASCULINITY: The traditional view of masculinity as being dominant, aggressive, and unemotional is no longer seen as the only way to be a man. Instead, there is an increasing awareness of the need for positive masculinity, which involves embracing healthy, positive, and respectful behaviors.

PATRIARCHY: Patriarchy is a system of relationships, beliefs, and values embedded in political, social, and economic systems that structure gender inequality between men and women.

SEX: Defines biological attributes (male, female).

UNPAID CARE WORK: non-market, unpaid work carried out in households (by women and girls primarily) includes both direct care (of persons) and indirect care (such as cooking, cleaning, fetching water and fuel, etc.)

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